

The Two Gentlemen of Verona

by William Shakespeare c. 1589-1593

Adapted for Avatar Repertory Theater from the Brandeis First Folio

by Judith Adele/Ada Radius

5 Notes:

Two Gentlemen is all about the fast witty banter with questionable moral values. Love conquers all, the equivalent of a modern rom-com. If this is performed as it was in the 16thC, fast and with simple carryon set pieces, running time is about 2 hours.

10 I conformed printing characters: j for i, u for v, v for u, vv to w, fixed obvious typos and connected a few hyphenations to make it easier to speak.

I did not change spelling or punctuation. Elizabethan and Jacobean spelling is phonetic: sound it out, paying attention to rhythm, rhyme, and
15 understandability. Shakespeare writes in both prose and poetry. A poetic line may be split between two speeches. Punctuation matters. Line spacing often matters. **This is not grammar, it's stage direction.** Pause and breathe accordingly.

16th century English did not sound like modern posh Brit, so please don't
20 unless that's your native dialect. Some regional American and U.K. accents are closer (see history of Appalachia). It's not just consonents and vowel shapes - rhythm, phrasing and the length of the vowels can matter. See:

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shakespeare_in_Original_Pronunciation,
25 especially the bibliography. and <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WeW1eV7Oc5A> . And experiment.

To keep actors and directors from going nuts: I standardized character titles in italic caps, with the folio title in red italic, if different. The character titles in the folio may change, depending on scene and character
30 intent. **It's a stage direction.** Character names can also change within speeches, indicating differences in pronunciation, intent, or relationship between characters. For example, Anthonio's nickname for his servant Panthion is Panthino or Panthmo.

We are working on forming for readability on digital devices such as
35 Kindle, retaining the line breaks of the original printing, best possible.

Music is available in *Shakespeare's Songbook* by Ross W. Duffin. Also:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dGxdIJ63sc4>,
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9fq6jINAo>, <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/cdHujFicPEI>

- 40 Color coding is adapted from entertainment industry script standards (actor, sound, sets, props & costume, effects, notes). Chapter titles label each scene, with a list of the characters who will be playing in that scene.

Resources

- <https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeare-in-print/first-folio/>
45 <https://internetshakespeare.uvic.ca/Library/plays.html>
<https://www.rsc.org.uk/shakespeare>
https://www.loc.gov/resource/gdcwdl.wdl_11290/?st=gallery
<https://firstfolio.bodleian.ox.ac.uk/book.html>

Along with these references, I'm using a 60 year old copy of the Oxford English Dictionary, online Latin translators, and Gimp, for when I need to see if a smutch on the facsimile might actually be a comma. LibreOffice for editing, referring to some of the OCR transcriptions available online along with the scans themselves.

CHARACTERS.

Listed at the end of the play in the folio. I rearranged them by rank and relationship and added notes.

- DUKE OF MILAN*: Father to Silvia.
- 50 *SILVIA*: witty beloved of Valentine, Protheus and Thurio. auburn haired, fair, gray eyes, low forehead
EGLAMORE: agent for Silvia in her escape.
Ursula, nonspeaking, servant to Silvia
THURIO: a foolish and vain rivall, the Duke's pick for his daughter. Dark
55 skinned?
- VALENTINE*. Young **gentleman from Verona**, honorable, loves Silvia
SPEED: a witty clownish servant to Valentine.
1OUTLAW. Moyses
60 *2OUTLAW*. Valerius
3OUTLAW.
- ANTHONIO*: father to Protheus.
PANTHION: or Panthino, servant to Anthonio.
- 65 *PROTHEUS*. Young **gentleman from Verona**, unfaithful, long winded.
LAUNCE: a morose clownish servant to Protheus.
- JULIA/Sebastion*: devoted to Protheus. blonde, gray eyes, high forehead
LUCETTA: witty waiting-woman to Julia.
- 70 *HOST*: where Julia lodges in Milan.

SCENES:

- A1S1 Verona.* Valentine, Protheus, Speed.
- A1S2 Verona, Julia's rooms.* Julia, Lucetta.
- 75 *A1S3 Verona.* Anthonio, Pantheon, Protheus.
- A2S1 Milan, the Duke's palace.* Valentine, Speed, Silvia.
- A2S2 Verona.* Protheus, Julia, Panthion.
- A2S3 Verona.* Launce, Panthion.
- 80 *A2S4 Milan, the Duke's palace.* Valentine, Silvia, Thurio, Speed, Duke, Protheus.
- A2S5 Padua.* Speed, Launce.
- A2S6 Milan.* Protheus.
- A2S7 Verona.* Julia, Lucetta.
- 85 *A3S1 Milan, the Duke's palace.* Duke, Thurio, Protheus, Valentine, Launce, Speed.
- A3S2 Milan, the Duke's palace.* Duke, Thurio, Protheus.
- A4S1 Road from Milano.* Valentine, Speed, Outlaws.
- A4S2 Milan. Outside the Duke's palace and Host's inn.* Protheus, Thurio, Julia, Host, Silvia, *NPC Musitian*
- 90 *A5S1 Milan, outside the abbey wall.* Eglamore, Silvia.
- A5S2 Milan, the Duke's palace.* Thurio, Protheus, Julia, Duke.
- A5S3 Forest.* Silvia, Out-lawes.
- A5S4 Forest.* Valentine, Protheus, Silvia, Julia, Duke, Thurio, Outlawes.

A1S1 Verona. *Valentine, Protheus, Speed*

Actus primus, Scena prima.

Valentine: Protheus, and Speed.

100 VALEN. Ceease to perswade, my loving Protheus;
Home-keeping youth, have ever homely wits,
Wer't not affection chaines thy tender dayes
To the sweet glaunces of thy honour'd love,
I rather would entreat thy company,
105 To see the wonders of the world abroad,
Then (living dully sluggardiz'd at home)
Weare out thy youth with shapelesse idlenesse.
But since thou lov'st; love still, and thrive therein,
Even as I would, when I to love begin.

110 PROTHERUS. Wilt thou be gone? Sweet Valentine adew,
Thinke on thy Protheus, when thou (hap'ly) seest
Some rare note-worthy object in thy travaile.
Wish me partaker in thy happinesse,
When thou do'st meet good hap; and in thy danger,
115 (If ever danger doe environ thee)
Commend thy grievance to my holy prayers,
For I will be thy beades-man, Valentine.

VALEN. And on a love-booke pray for my successe?

PROTHERUS. Upon some booke I love, I'll pray for thee.

120 VALEN. That's on some shallow Storie of deepe love,
How yong *Leander* crost the *Hellespont*.

PROTHERUS. That's a deepe Storie, of a deeper love,
For he was more then over-shooes in love.

125 VALEN. 'Tis true; for you are over-bootes in love,
And yet you never swom the *Hellespont*.

PROTHERUS. Over the Bootes? nay give me not the Boots.

VALEN. No, I will not; for it boots thee not.

PROTHERUS. What?

130 VALEN. To be in love; where scorne is bought with grones:
Coy looks, with hart-sore sighes: one fading moments mirth,
With twenty watchfull, weary, tedious nights;
If hap'ly won, perhaps a haplesse gaine;

If lost, why then a grievous labour won;
How ever: but a folly bought with wit,
135 Or else a wit, by folly vanquished.

PROTHEUS. So, by your circumstance, you call me foole.

VALEN. So, by your circumstance, I feare you'll prove.

PROTHEUS. 'Tis Love you cavvill at, I am not Love.

VALEN. Love is your master, for he masters you;
140 And he that is so yoked by a foole,
Me thinkes should not be chronicled for wise.

PROTHEUS. Yet Writers say; as in the sweetest Bud,
The eating Canker dwels; so eating Love
Inhabits in the finest wits of all.

145 *VALEN.* And Writers say; as the most forward Bud
Is eaten by the Canker ere it blow,
Even so by Love, the yong, and tender wit
Is turn'd to folly, blasting in the Bud,
Loosing his verdure, even in the prime,
150 And all the faire effects of future hopes.
But wherefore waste I time to counsaile thee
That art a votary to fond desire?
Once more adieu: my Father at the Road
Expects my comming, there to see me ship'd.

155 *PROTHEUS.* And thither will I bring thee *Valentine*.

VALEN. Sweet *Protheus*, no: Now let us take our leave:
To *Millaine* let me heare from thee by Letters
Of thy successe in love; and what newes else
Betideth here in absence of thy Friend:
160 And I likewise will visite thee with mine.

PROTHEUS. All happinesse bechance to thee in *Millaine*.

VALEN. As much to you at home: and so farewell. *Exit.*

PROTHEUS. He after Honour hunts, I after Love;
He leaves his friends, to dignifie them more;
165 I love my selfe, my friends, and all for love:
Thou *Julia*, thou hast metamorphis'd me:
Made me neglect my Studies, loose my time;
Warre with good counsaile; set the world at nought;
Made Wit with musing, weake; hart sick with thought.

170 *SPEED.* Sir *Protheus*: 'save you: saw you my Master?
 PROTHEUS. But now he parted hence to embarque for *Millain*.
 SPEED. Twenty to one then, he is ship'd already,
And I have plaid the Sheepe in loosing him.
 PROTHEUS. Indeede a Sheepe doth very often stray,
175 And if the Shepheard be awhile away.
 SPEED. You conclude that my Master is a Shepheard then,
and I Sheepe?
 PROTHEUS. I doe.
 SPEED. Why then my hornes are his hornes, whether I
180 wake or sleepe.
 PROTHEUS. A silly answer, and fitting well a Sheepe.
 SPEED. This proves me still a Sheepe.
 PROTHEUS. True: and thy Master a Shepheard.
 SPEED. Nay, that I can deny by a circumstance.
185 *PROTHEUS.* It shall goe hard but ile prove it by another.
 SPEED. The Shepheard seekes the Sheepe, and not the
Sheepe the Shepheard; but I seeke my Master, and my
Master seekes not me: therefore I am no Sheepe.
 PROTHEUS. The Sheepe for fodder follow the Shepheard,
190 the Shepheard for foode followes not the Sheepe: thou
for wages followest thy Master, thy Master for wages
followes not thee: therefore thou art a Sheepe.
 SPEED. Such another prooffe will make me cry baâ.
 PROTHEUS. But do'st thou heare: gav'st thou my Letter
195 to *Julia*?
 SPEED. Aye Sir: I (a lost-Mutton) gave your Letter to her
(a lac'd-Mutton) and she (a lac'd-Mutton) gave mee (a
lost-Mutton) nothing for my labour.
 PROTHEUS. Here's too small a Pasture for such store of
200 Muttons.
 SPEED. If the ground be over-charg'd, you were best
sticke her.

PROTHEUS. Nay, in that you are astray: 'twere best pound
you.

205 *SPEED.* Nay Sir, lesse then a pound shall serve me for carrying
your Letter.

PROTHEUS. You mistake; I meane the pound, a Pinfold.

SPEED. From a pound to a pin? fold it over and over,
'Tis threefold too little for carrying a letter to your lover

210 *PROTHEUS.* But what said she?

SPEED. Aye.

PROTHEUS. Nod-I, why that's noddy.

SPEED. You mistooke Sir: I say she did nod;
And you aske me if she did nod, and I say aye.

215 *PROTHEUS.* And that set together is noddy.

SPEED. Now you have taken the paines to set it together,
take it for your paines.

PROTHEUS. No, no, you shall have it for bearing the letter.

SPEED. Well, I perceive I must be faine to beare with you.

220 *PROTHEUS.* Why Sir, how doe you beare with me?

SPEED. Marry Sir, the letter very orderly,
Having nothing but the word noddy for my paines.

PROTHEUS. Beshrew me, but you have a quicke wit.

SPEED. And yet it cannot over-take your slow purse.

225 *PROTHEUS.* Come, come, open the matter in briefe; what
said she.

SPEED. Open your purse, that the money, and the matter
may be both at once delivered.

PROTHEUS. Well Sir: here is for your paines: what said she?

230 *SPEED.* Truely Sir, I thinke you'll hardly win her.

PROTHEUS. Why? could'st thou perceive so much from her?

SPEED. Sir, I could perceive nothing at all from her;
No, not so much as a ducket for delivering your letter:
And being so hard to me, that brought your minde;

235 I feare she'll prove as hard to you in telling your minde.
Give her no token but stones, for she's as hard as steele.

PROTHEUS. What said she, nothing?

SPEED. No, not so much as take this for thy pains:
To testifie your bounty, I thank you, you have cestern'd me;
240 In requital whereof, henceforth, carry your letters your
selfe; And so Sir, I'll commend you to my Master.

PROTHEUS. Go, go, be gone, to save your Ship from wrack,
Which cannot perish having thee aboarde,
Being destin'd to a drier death on shore:
245 I must goe send some better Messenger,
I feare my *Julia* would not daigne my lines,
Receiving them from such a worthlesse post. *Exit.*

A1S2 Verona, Julia's rooms. Julia, Lucetta.

250 ***Scoena Secunda.***
Enter Julia and Lucetta.

JULIA. But say *Lucetta* (now we are alone)
Would'st thou then counsaile me to fall in love?

LUCETTA. Aye Madam, so you stumble not unheedfully.

255 *JULIA.* Of all the faire resort of Gentlemen,
That every day with par'le encounter me,
In thy opinion which is worthiest love?

LUCETTA. Please you repeat their names, ile shew my minde,
According to my shallow simple skill.

260 *JULIA.* What thinkst thou of the faire sir *Eglamoure*?

LUCETTA. As of a Knight, well-spoken, neat, and fine;
But were I you, he never should be mine.

JULIA. What think'st thou of the rich *Mercatio*?

LUCETTA. Well of his wealth; but of himselfe, so, so.

265 *JULIA.* What think'st thou of the gentle *Protheus*?

LUCETTA. Lord, Lord: to see what folly raignes in us.

JULIA. How now? what meanes this passion at his name?

LUCETTA. Pardon deare Madam, 'tis a passing shame,
 That I (unworthy body as I am)
 270 Should censure thus on lovely Gentlemen.

 JULIA. Why not on *Protheus*, as of all the rest?
 LUCETTA. Then thus: of many good, I thinke him best.
 JULIA. Your reason?
 LUCETTA. I have no other but a womans reason:
 275 I thinke him so, because I thinke him so.

 JULIA. And would'st thou have me cast my love on him?
 LUCETTA. Aye: if you thought your love not cast away.
 JULIA. Why he, of all the rest, hath never mov'd me.
 LUCETTA. Yet he, of all the rest, I thinke best loves ye.
 280 JULIA. His little speaking, shewes his love but small.
 LUCETTA. Fire that's closest kept, burnes most of all.
 JULIA. They doe not love, that doe not shew their love.
 LUCETTA. Oh, they love least, that let men know their love.
 JULIA. I would I knew his minde.
 285 LUCETTA. Peruse this paper Madam.
 JULIA. To *Julia*: say, from whom?
 LUCETTA. That the Contents will shew.
 JULIA. Say, say: who gave it thee?
 LUCETTA. Sir *Valentines* page: & sent I think from *Protheus*;
 290 He would have given it you, but I being in the way,
 Did in your name receive it: pardon the fault I pray.

 JULIA. Now (by my modesty) a goodly Broker:
 Dare you presume to harbour wanton lines?
 To whisper, and conspire against my youth?
 295 Now trust me, 'tis an office of great worth,
 And you an officer fit for the place:
 There: take the paper: see it be return'd,
 Or else returne no more into my sight.

 LUCETTA. To plead for love, deserves more fee, then hate.
 300 JULIA. Will ye be gon?

LUCETTA. That you may ruminate. *Exit.*

JULIA. And yet I would I had ore-look'd the Letter;
It were a shame to call her backe again,
And pray her to a fault, for which I chid her.
305 What 'foole is she, that knowes I am a Maid,
And would not force the letter to my view?
Since Maides, in modesty, say no, to that,
Which they would have the profferer construe, aye.
Fie, fie: how way-ward is this foolish love;
310 That (like a testie Babe) will scratch the Nurse,
And presently, all humbled kisse the Rod?
How churlishly, I chid *Lucetta* hence,
When willingly, I would have had her here?
How angerly I taught my brow to frowne,
315 When inward joy enforc'd my heart to smile?
My pennance is, to call *Lucetta* backe
And aske remission, for my folly past.
What hoe: *Lucetta*.

LUCETTA. What would your Ladiship?

320 *JULIA.* Is't neere dinner time?

LUCETTA. I would it were,
That you might kill your stomacke on your meat,
And not upon your Maid.

JULIA. What is't that you
325 Tooke up so gingerly?

LUCETTA. Nothing.

JULIA. Why didst thou stoope then?

LUCETTA. To take a paper up, that I let fall.

JULIA. And is that paper nothing?

330 *LUCETTA.* Nothing concerning me.

JULIA. Then let it lye, for those that it concernes.

LUCETTA. Madam, it will not lye where it concernes,
Unlesse it have a false Interpreter.

JULIA. Some love of yours, hath writ to you in Rime.

335 *LUCETTA.* That I might sing it (Madam) to a tune:
Give me a Note, your Ladiship can set

JULIA. As little by such toyes, as may be possible:
Best sing it to the tune of *Light O, Love*.

LUCETTA. It is too heavy for so light a tune.

340 *JULIA.* Heavy? belike it hath some burden then?

LUCETTA. Aye: and melodious were it, would you sing it,

JULIA. And why not you?

LUCETTA. I cannot reach so high.

JULIA. Let's see your Song:
345 How now Minion?

LUCETTA. Keepe tune there still; so you will sing it out:
And yet me thinkes I do not like this tune.

JULIA. You doe not?

LUCETTA. No (Madam) tis too sharpe.

350 *JULIA.* You (Minion) are too saucie.

LUCETTA. Nay, now you are too flat;
And marre the concord, with too harsh a descant:
There wanteth but a Meane to fill your Song.

JULIA. The meane is dround with you unruly base.

355 *LUCETTA.* Indeede I bid the base for *Protheus*.

JULIA. This babble shall not henceforth trouble me;
Here is a coile with protestation:
Goe, get you gone: and let the papers lye:
You would be fingring them, to anger me.

360 *LUCETTA.* She makes it strāge, but she would be best pleas'd
To be so angred with another Letter.

JULIA. Nay, would I were so angred with the same:
Oh hatefull hands, to teare such loving words;
Injurious Waspes, to feede on such sweet hony,
365 And kill the Bees that yeelde it, with your stings;
Ile kisse each severall paper, for amends:
Looke, here is writ, kinde *Julia*: unkinde *Julia*,
As in revenge of thy ingratitude,
I throw thy name against the bruizing-stones,
370 Trampling contemptuously on thy disdaine.
And here is writ, *Love wounded Protheus*.

Poore wounded name: my bosome, as a bed,
 Shall lodge thee till thy wound be throughly heal'd;
 And thus I search it with a soveraigne kisse.
 375 But twice, or thrice, was *Protheus* written downe:
 Be calme (good winde) blow not a word away,
 Till I have found each letter, in the Letter,
 Except mine own name: That, some whirle-winde beare
 Unto a ragged, fearefull, hanging Rocke,
 380 And throw it thence into the raging Sea.
 Loe, here in one line is his name twice writ:
 Poore forlorne *Protheus*, passionate *Protheus*:
To the sweet Julia: that ile teare away:
 And yet I will not, sith so prettily
 385 He couples it, to his complaining Names;
 Thus will I fold them, one upon another;
 Now kisse, embrace, contend, doe what you will.

LUCETTA. Madam: dinner is ready: and your father staies.
JULIA. Well, let us goe.

390 *LUCETTA*. What, shall these papers lye, like Tel-tales here?
JULIA. If you respect them; best to take them up.

LUCETTA. Nay, I was taken up, for laying them downe.
 Yet here they shall not lye, for catching cold.

JULIA. I see you have a months minde to them.

395 *LUCETTA*. Aye (Madam) you may say what sights you see;
 I see things too, although you judge I winke.

JULIA. Come, come, wilt please you goe. *Exeunt.*

A1S3 Verona. *Anthonio, Pantheon, Protheus.*

400 ***Scoena Tertia.***
Enter Antonio and Panthino. Protheus.

ANTONIO. Tell me *Panthino*, what sad talke was that,
 Wherewith my brother held you in the Cloyster?

PANTHION. 'Twas of his Nephew *Protheus*, your Sonne.

405 *ANTONIO*. Why? what of him?

PANTHION. He wondred that your Lordship
 Would suffer him, to spend his youth at home,

While other men, of slender reputation
Put forth their Sonnes, to seeke preferment out.
410 Some to the warres, to try their fortune there;
Some, to discover Islands farre away:
Some, to the studious Universities;
For any, or for all these exercises,
He said, that *Protheus*, your sonne, was meet;
415 And did request me, to importune you
To let him spend his time no more at home;
Which would be great impeachment to his age,
In having knowne no travaile in his youth.

ANTONIO. Nor need'st thou much importune me to that
420 Whereon, this month I have bin hamering.
I have consider'd well, his losse of time,
And how he cannot be a perfect man,
Not being tryed, and tutord in the world:
Experience is by industry atchiev'd,
425 And perfected by the swift course of time:
Then tell me, whether were I best to send him?

PANTHION. I thinke your Lordship is not ignorant
How his companion, youthfull *Valentine*,
Attends the Emperour in his royall Court.

430 *ANTONIO*. I know it well.

PANTHION. 'Twere good, I thinke, your Lordship sent him thither,
There shall he practise Tilts, and Turnaments;
Heare sweet discourse, converse with Noble-men,
And be in eye of every Exercise
435 Worthy his youth, and noblenesse of birth.

ANTONIO. I like thy counsaile: well hast thou advis'd:
And that thou maist perceive how well I like it,
The execution of it shall make knowne;
Even with the speediest expedition,
440 I will dispatch him to the Emperors Court.

PANTHION. To morrow, may it please you, *Don Alphonso*,
With other Gentlemen of good esteeme
Are journeying, to salute the *Emperor*,
And to commend their service to his will.

445 *ANTONIO*. Good company: with them shall *Protheus* go:
And in good time: now will we breake with him.

PROTHEUS. Sweet Love, sweet lines, sweet life,
Here is her hand, the agent of her heart;
Here is her oath for love, her honors paune;
450 O that our Fathers would applaud our loves
To seale our happinesse with their consents.
Oh heavenly *Julia*.

ANTONIO. How now? What Letter are you reading there?

PROTHEUS. May't please your Lordship, 'tis a word or two
455 Of commendations sent from *Valentine*;
Deliver'd by a friend, that came from him.

ANTONIO. Lend me the Letter: Let me see what newes.

PROTHEUS. There is no newes (my Lord) but that he writes
How happily he lives, how well-belov'd,
460 And daily graced by the Emperor;
Wishing me with him, partner of his fortune.

ANTONIO. And how stand you affected to his wish?

PROTHEUS. As one relying on your Lordships will,
And not depending on his friendly wish.

465 *ANTONIO*. My will is something sorted with his wish:
Muse not that I thus sodainly proceed;
For what I will, I will, and there an end:
I am resolv'd, that thou shalt spend some time
With *Valentinus*, in the Emperors Court:
470 What maintenance he from his friends receives,
Like exhibition thou shalt have from me,
To morrow be in readinesse, to goe,
Excuse it not: for I am peremptory.

PROTHEUS. My Lord I cannot be so soone provided,
475 Please you deliberate a day or two.

ANTONIO. Look what thou want'st shal be sent after thee:
No more of stay: to morrow thou must goe;
Come on *Panthmo*; you shall be imployd,
To hasten on his Expedition. *[Exit]*

480 *PROTHEUS*. Thus have I shund the fire, for feare of burning,
And drench'd me in the sea, where I am drown'd.
I fear'd to shew my Father *Julias* Letter,
Least he should take exceptions to my love,
And with the vantage of mine owne excuse

485 Hath he excepted most against my love.
Oh, how this spring of love resembleth
The uncertaine glory of an Aprill day,
Which now shewes all the beauty of the Sun,
And by and by a clowd takes all away.

490 *PANTHION*. Sir *Protheus*, your Fathers call's for you,
He is in hast, therefore I pray you go.

PROTHEUS. Why this it is: my heart accords thereto,
And yet a thousand times it answer's no. *Exeunt. Finis.*

495 **A2S1 Milan, the Duke's palace.** *Valentine, Speed, Silvia.*

Actus secundus: Scoena Prima.

Enter Valentine, Speed, Silvia.

SPEED. your Glove.

VALEN. Not mine: my Gloves are on.

500 *SPEED*. Why then this may be yours: for this is but one.

VALEN. Ha? Let me see: I, give it me, it's mine:
Sweet Ornament, that deckes a thing divine,
Ah *Silvia*, *Silvia*.

SPEED. Madam *Silvia*: Madam *Silvia*.

505 *VALEN*. How now Sirha?

SPEED. Shee is not within hearing Sir.

VALEN. Why sir, who bad you call her?

SPEED. Your worship sir, or else I mistooke.

VALEN. Well: you'll still be too forward.

510 *SPEED*. And yet I was last chidden for being too slow.

VALEN. Goe to, sir, tell me: do you know Madam *Silvia*?

SPEED. Shee that your worship loves?

VALEN. Why, how know you that I am in love?

SPEED. Marry by these speciall markes: first, you have
515 learn'd (like Sir *Protheus*) to wreath your Armes like a
Male-content: to relish a Love-song, like a *Robin*-red-
breast: to walke alone like one that had the pestilence:
to sigh, like a Schoole-boy that had lost his *A.B.C.* to

weep like a yong wench that had buried her Grandam:
520 to fast, like one that takes diet: to watch, like one that
feares robbing: to speake puling, like a beggar at Hal-
low-Masse: You were wont, when you laughed, to crow
like a cocke; when you walk'd, to walke like one of the
Lions: when you fasted, it was presently after dinner:
525 when you look'd sadly, it was for want of money: And
now you are Metamorphis'd with a Mistris, that when I
looke on you, I can hardly thinke you my Master.

VALEN. Are all these things perceiv'd in me?

SPEED. They are all perceiv'd without ye.

530 *VALEN.* Without me? they cannot.

SPEED. Without you? nay, that's certaine: for without
you were so simple, none else would: but you are
so without these follies, that these follies are within you,
and shine through you like the water in an Urinall: that
535 not an eye that sees you, but is a Physician to comment
on your Malady.

VALEN. But tell me: do'st thou know my Lady *Silvia*?

SPEED. Shee that you gaze on so, as she sits at supper?

VALEN. Hast thou observ'd that? even she I meane.

540 *SPEED.* Why sir, I know her not.

VALEN. Do'st thou know her by my gazing on her, and
yet know'st her not?

SPEED. Is she not hard-favour'd, sir?

VALEN. Not so faire (boy) as well favour'd.

545 *SPEED.* Sir, I know that well enough.

VALEN. What dost thou know?

SPEED. That shee is not so faire, as (of you) well-favour'd?

VALEN. I meane that her beauty is exquisite,
But her favour infinite.

550 *SPEED.* That's because the one is painted, and the other
out of all count.

VALEN. How painted? and how out of count?

SPEED. Marry sir, so painted to make her faire, that no man counts of her beauty.

555 *VALEN.* How esteem'st thou me? I account of her beauty.

SPEED. You never saw her since she was deform'd.

VALEN. How long hath she beene deform'd?

SPEED. Ever since you lov'd her.

560 *VALEN.* I have lov'd her ever since I saw her,
And still I see her beautifull.

SPEED. If you love her, you cannot see her.

VALEN. Why?

565 *SPEED.* Because Love is blinde: O that you had mine eyes, or your owne eyes had the lights they were wont to have, when you chidde at Sir *Protheus*, for going ungarter'd.

VALEN. What should I see then?

570 *SPEED.* Your owne present folly, and her passing deformitie: for hee beeing in love, could not see to garter his hose; and you, beeing in love, cannot see to put on your hose.

VALEN. Belike (boy) then you are in love, for last morning You could not see to wipe my shooes.

575 *SPEED.* True sir: I was in love with my bed, I thanke you, you swing'd me for my love, which makes mee the bolder to chide you, for yours.

VALEN. In conclusion, I stand affected to her.

SPEED. I would you were set, so your affection would cease.

580 *VALEN.* Last night she enjoyn'd me,
To write some lines to one she loves.

SPEED. And have you?

VALEN. I have.

SPEED. Are they not lamely writt?

585 *VALEN.* No (Boy) but as well as I can do them:
Peace, here she comes.

SPEED. Oh excellent motion; oh exceeding Puppet:
Now will he interpret to her. *[enter Silvia]*

VALEN. Madam & Mistres, a thousand good-morrows.

590 *SPEED.* Oh, 'give ye-good-ev'n: heer's a million of
manners.

SILVIA. Sir *Valentine*, and servant, to you two thousand.

SPEED. He should give her interest: & she gives it him.

VALEN. As you injoynd me; I have writ your Letter
Unto the secret, nameles friend of yours:
595 Which I was much unwilling to proceed in,
But for my duty to your Ladiship.

SILVIA. I thanke you (gentle Servant) 'tis very Clerkly-done.

VALEN. Now trust me (Madam) it came hardly-off:
For being ignorant to whom it goes,
600 I writ at randome, very doubtfully.

SILVIA. Perchance you think too much of so much pains?

VALEN. No (Madam) so it steed you, I will write
(Please you command) a thousand times as much:
And yet ---

605 *SILVIA.* A pretty period: well: I ghesse the sequell;
And yet I will not name it: and yet I care not.
And yet, take this againe: and yet I thanke you:
Meaning henceforth to trouble you no more.

SPEED. And yet you will: and yet, another yet.

610 *VALEN.* What meanes your Ladiship?
Doe you not like it?

SILVIA. Yes, yes: the lines are very queintly writ,
But (since unwillingly) take them againe.
Nay, take them.

615 *VALEN.* Madam, they are for you.

SILVIA. Aye, aye: you writ them Sir, at my request,
But I will none of them: they are for you:
I would have had them writ more movingly:

VALEN. Please you, Ile write your Ladiship another.

620 *SILVIA*. And when it's writ: for my sake read it over,
And if it please you, so: if not: why so:

VALEN. If it please me, (Madam?) what then?

SILVIA. Why if it please you, take it for your labour;
And so good-morrow Servant. *Exit. Sil.*

625 *SPEED*. Oh Jest unseene: inscrutable: invisible,
As a nose on a mans face, or a Wethercocke on a steeple:
My Master sues to her: and she hath taught her Tutor,
He being her Pupill, to become her Tutor.
Oh excellent devise, was there ever heard a better?

630 That my master being scribe,
To himselfe should write the Letter?

VALEN. How now Sir?
What are you reasoning with your selfe?

SPEED. Nay: I was riming: 'tis you yt have the reason.

635 *VALEN*. To doe what?

SPEED. To be a Spokes-man from Madam *Silvia*.

VALEN. To whom?

SPEED. To your selfe: why, she woes you by a figure.

VALEN. What figure?

640 *SPEED*. By a Letter, I should say.

VALEN. Why she hath not writ to me?

SPEED. What need she,
When shee hath made you write to your selfe?
Why, doe you not perceive the jest?

645 *VALEN*. No, beleeve me.

SPEED. No beleeving you indeed sir:
But did you perceive her earnest?

VALEN. She gave me none, except an angry word.

SPEED. Why she hath given you a Letter.

650 *VALEN*. That's the Letter I writ to her friend.

SPEED. And yt letter hath she deliver'd, & there an end.

VALEN. I would it were no worse.

SPEED. Ile warrant you, 'tis as well:
For often have you writ to her: and she in modesty,
655 Or else for want of idle time, could not againe reply,
Or fearing els some messēger, yt might her mind discover
Her self hath taught her Love himself, to write unto her lover.
All this I speak in print, for in print I found it.
Why muse you sir, 'tis dinner time.

660 *VALEN.* I have dyn'd.

SPEED. Aye, but hearken sir: though the Cameleon Love
can feed on the ayre, I am one that am nourish'd by my
victuals; and would faine have meate: oh bee not like
your Mistresse, be moved, be moved. *Exeunt.*

665

A2S2 Verona. *Protheus, Julia, Panthion*

Scoena secunda.

Enter Protheus, Julia, Panthion.

PROTHEUS. Have patience, gentle *Julia*:

670 *JULIA.* I must where is no remedy.

PROTHEUS. When possibly I can, I will returne.

JULIA. If you turne not: you will return the sooner:
Keepe this remembrance for thy *Julia's* sake.

PROTHEUS. Why then wee'll make exchange;
675 Here, take you this.

JULIA. And seale the bargaine with a holy kisse. *[Kiss, exit]*

PROTHEUS. Here is my hand, for my true constancie:
And when that howre ore-slips me in the day,
Wherein I sigh not (*Julia*) for thy sake,
680 The next ensuing howre, some foule mischance
Torment me for my Loves forgetfulnesse:
My father staies my comming: answere not:
The tide is now; nay, not thy tide of teares,
That tide will stay me longer then I should,
685 *Julia*, farewell: what, gon without a word?
Aye, so true love should doe: it cannot speake,
For truth hath better deeds, then words to grace it.

PANTHION. Sir *Protheus*: you are staid for.

PROTHEUS. Goe: I come, I come:
690 Alas, this parting strikes poore Lovers dumbe. *Exeunt.*

A2S3 Verona. *Launce, Panthion.*

Scoena Tertia.

695 *Enter Launce [with a shoe in each hand and a staff, wearing a hat],
[and Crabbe the NPC dog], Panthion.*

LAUNCE. Nay, 'twill bee this howre ere I have done
weeping: all the kinde of the *Launces*, have this very
fault: I have receiv'd my proportion, like the prodigious
Sonne, and am going with Sir *Protheus* to the Imperialls
700 Court: I thinke *Crab* my dog, be the sowrest natured
dogge that lives: My Mother weeping: my Father
wayling: my Sister crying: our Maid howling: our
Catte wringing her hands, and all our house in a great
perplexitie, yet did not this cruell-hearted Curre shedde
705 one teare: he is a stone, a very pibble stone, and has no
more pittie in him then a dogge: a Jew would have wept
to have seene our parting: why my Grandam having
no eyes, looke you, wept her selfe blinde at my parting:
nay, Ile shew you the manner of it. This shooe is my father:
710 no, this left shooe is my father; no, no, this left
shooe is my mother: nay, that cannot bee so neyther:
yes; it is so, it is so: it hath the worser sole: this shooe
with the hole in it, is my mother: and this my father:
a veng'ance on't, there 'tis: Now sir, this staffe is my sister:
715 for, looke you, she is as white as a lilly, and as
small as a wand: this hat is *Nan* our maid: I am the
dogge: no, the dogge is himselfe, and I am the dogge:
oh, the dogge is me, and I am my selfe: Aye; so, so: now
come I to my Father; Father, your blessing: now
720 should not the shooe speake a word for weeping:
now should I kisse my Father; well, hee weepes on:
Now come I to my Mother: Oh that she could speake
now, like a would-woman: well, I kisse her: why
there 'tis; heere's my mothers breath up and downe:
725 Now come I to my sister; marke the moane she makes:
now the dogge all this while sheds not a teare: nor
speakes a word: but see how I lay the dust with my
teares.

730 *PANTHION.* *Launce*, away, away: a Boord: thy Master is
ship'd, and thou art to post after with oares; what's the
matter? why weep'st thou man? away asse, you'l loose
the Tide, if you tarry any longer.

LAUNCE. It is no matter if the tide were lost, for it is the
unkindest Tide, that ever any man tide.

735 *PANTHION.* What's the unkindest tide?

LAUNCE. Why, he that's tide here, *Crab* my dog.

PANTHION. Tut, man: I meane thou'lt loose the flood, and
in loosing the flood, loose thy voyage, and in loosing thy
voyage, loose thy Master, and in loosing thy Master,
740 loose thy service, and in loosing thy service: --- why
dost thou stop my mouth?

LAUNCE. For feare thou shouldst loose thy tongue.

PANTHION. Where should I loose my tongue?

LAUNCE. In thy Tale.

745 *PANTHION.* In thy Taile.

LAUNCE. Loose the Tide, and the voyage, and the Master,
and the Service, and the tide: why man, if the River
were drie, I am able to fill it with my teares: if the winde
were downe, I could drive the boate with my sighes.

750 *PANTHION.* Come: come away man, I was sent to call
thee.

LAUNCE. Sir: call me what thou dar'st.

PANTHION. Wilt thou goe?

LAUNCE. Well, I will goe. *Exeunt.*

755

A2S4 Milan, the Duke's palace. *Valentine, Silvia, Thurio, Speed, Duke,*
Protheus.

Scena Quarta.

Enter Valentine, Silvia, Thurio, Speed, Duke, Protheus.

760 *SILVIA.* Servant.

VALEN. Mistris.

SPEED. Master, Sir *Thurio* frownes on you.

VALEN. Aye Boy, it's for love.

SPEED. Not of you.

765 *VALEN.* Of my Mistresse then.

SPEED. 'Twere good you knockt him.

SILVIA. Servant, you are sad.

VALEN. Indeed, Madam, I seeme so.

THURIO. Seeme you that you are not?

770 *VALEN.* Hap'ly I doe.

THURIO. So doe Counterfeyts.

VALEN. So doe you.

THURIO. What seeme I that I am not?

VALEN. Wise.

775 *THURIO.* What instance of the contrary?

VALEN. Your folly.

THURIO. And how quoad you my folly?

VALEN. I quoad it in your Jerkin.

THURIO. My Jerkin is a doublet.

780 *VALEN.* Well then, Ile double your folly.

THURIO. How?

SILVIA. What, angry, Sir *Thurio*, do you change colour?

VALEN. Give him leave, Madam, he is a kind of *Camelion*.

785 *THURIO.* That hath more minde to feed on your bloud,
then live in your ayre.

VALEN. You have said Sir.

THURIO. Aye Sir, and done too for this time.

VALEN. I know it wel sir, you alwaies end ere you begin.

SILVIA. A fine volly of words, gentlemē, & quickly shot off

790 *VALEN.* 'Tis indeed, Madam, we thank the giver.

SILVIA. Who is that Servant?

VALEN. Your selfe (sweet Lady) for you gave the fire,
Sir *Thurio* borrows his wit from your Ladships lookes,
And spends what he borrowes kindly in your company.

795 *THURIO*. Sir, if you spend word for word with me, I shall
make your wit bankrupt.

VALEN. I know it well sir: you have an Exchequer of (words,
And I thinke, no other treasure to give your followers:
For it appeares by their bare Liveries
800 That they live by your bare words.

SILVIA. No more, gentlemen, no more:
Here comes my father.

DUKE. Now, daughter *Silvia*, you are hard beset.
Sir *Valentine*, your father is in good health,
805 What say you to a Letter from your friends
Of much good newes?

VALEN. My Lord, I will be thankfull,
To any happy messenger from thence.

DUKE. Know ye *Don Antonio*, your Countriman?

810 *VALEN*. Aye, my good Lord, I know the Gentleman
To be of worth, and worthy estimation,
And not without desert so well reputed.

DUKE. Hath he not a Sonne?

VALEN. Aye, my good Lord, a Son, that well deserves
815 The honor, and regard of such a father.

DUKE. You know him well?

VALEN. I knew him as my selfe: for from our Infancie
We have converst, and spent our howres together,
And though my selfe have beene an idle Trewant,
820 Omitting the sweet benefit of time
To cloath mine age with Angel-like perfection:
Yet hath Sir *Protheus* (for that's his name)
Made use, and faire advantage of his daies:
His yeares but yong, but his experience old:
825 His head un-mellowed, but his Judgement ripe;
And in a word (for far behinde his worth
Comes all the praises that I now bestow.)
He is compleat in feature, and in minde,
With all good grace, to grace a Gentleman.

830 *DUKE*. Beshrew me sir, but if he make this good
He is as worthy for an Empresse love,
As meet to be an Emperors Councillor:

Well, Sir: this Gentleman is come to me
With Commendation from great Potentates,
835 And heere he meanes to spend his time a while,
I thinke 'tis no un-welcome newes to you.

VALEN. Should I have wish'd a thing, it had beene he.

DUKE. Welcome him then according to his worth:
Silvia, I speake to you, and you Sir *Thurio*,
840 For *Valentine*, I need not cite him to it,
I will send him hither to you presently.

VALEN. This is the Gentleman I told your Ladiship
Had come along with me, but that his Mistresse
Did hold his eyes, lockt in her Christall looks.

845 *SILVIA*. Be-like that now she hath enfranchis'd them
Upon some other pawne for fealty.

VALEN. Nay sure, I thinke she holds them prisoners stil.

SILVIA. Nay then he should be blind, and being blind
How could he see his way to seeke out you?

850 VALEN. Why Lady, Love hath twenty paire of eyes.

THURIO. They say that Love hath not an eye at all.

VALEN. To see such Lovers, *Thurio*, as your selfe,
Upon a homely obiect, Love can winke.

SILVIA. Have done, have done: here comes ye gentleman.

855 *Enter Protheus*

VALEN. Welcome, deer *Protheus*: Mistris, I beseech you
Confirme his welcome, with some speciall favor.

SILVIA. His worth is warrant for his welcome hether,
If this be he you oft have wish'd to heare from.

860 VALEN. Mistris, it is: sweet Lady, entertaine him
To be my fellow-servant to your Ladiship.

SILVIA. Too low a Mistres for so high a servant.

PROTHEUS. Not so, sweet Lady, but too meane a servant
To have a looke of such a worthy a Mistresse.

865 VALEN. Leave off discourse of disabilitie:
Sweet Lady, entertaine him for your Servant.

PROTHEUS. My dutie will I boast of, nothing else.

SILVIA. And dutie never yet did want his meed.
Servant, you are welcome to a worthlesse Mistresse.

870 *PROTHEUS.* Ile die on him that saies so but your selfe.

SILVIA. That you are welcome?

PROTHEUS. That you are worthlesse.

THURIO. Madam, my Lord your father wold speak with you.

SILVIA. I wait upon his pleasure: Come Sir *Thurio*,
875 Goe with me: once more, new Servant welcome;
Ile leave you to confer of home affaires,
When you have done, we looke too heare from you. *[Exit Silvia, Thurio]*

PROTHEUS. Wee'll both attend upon your Ladiship.

VALEN. Now tell me: how do al from whence you came?

880 *PROTHEUS.* Your frends are wel, & have thē much cōmended.

VALEN. And how doe yours?

PROTHEUS. I left them all in health.

VALEN. How does your Lady? & how thrives your love?

PROTHEUS. My tales of Love were wont to weary you,
885 I know you joy not in a Love-discourse.

VALEN. Aye *Protheus*, but that life is alter'd now,
I have done pennance for contemning Love,
Whose high emperious thoughts have punish'd me
With bitter fasts, with penitentiall grones,
890 With nightly teares, and daily hart-sore sighes,
For in revenge of my contempt of love,
Love hath chas'd sleepe from my enthralled eyes,
And made them watchers of mine owne hearts sorrow.
O gentle *Protheus*, Love's a mighty Lord,
895 And hath so humbled me, as I confesse
There is no woe to his correction,
Nor to his Service, no such joy on earth:
Now, no discourse, except it be of love:
Now can I breake my fast, dine, sup, and sleepe,
900 Upon the very naked name of Love.

PROTHEUS. Enough; I read your fortune in your eye:
Was this the Idoll, that you worship so?

VALEN. Even She; and is she not a heavenly Saint?

PROTHEUS. No; But she is an earthly Paragon.

905 *VALEN.* Call her divine.

PROTHEUS. I will not flatter her.

VALEN. O flatter me: for Love delights in praises.

PROTHEUS. When I was sick, you gave me bitter pils,
And I must minister the like to you.

910 *VALEN.* Then speake the truth by her; if not divine,
Yet let her be a principalitie,
Soveraigne to all the Creatures on the earth.

PROTHEUS. Except my Mistresse.

VALEN. Sweet: except not any,
915 Except thou wilt except against my Love.

PROTHEUS. Have I not reason to prefer mine owne?

VALEN. And I will help thee to prefer her to:
Shee shall be dignified with this high honour,
To beare my Ladies traine, lest the base earth
920 Should from her vesture chance to steale a kisse,
And of so great a favor growing proud,
Disdaine to roote the Sommer-swelling flowre,
And make rough winter everlastingly.

PROTHEUS. Why *Valentine*, what Bragadisme is this?

925 *VALEN.* Pardon me (*Protheus*) all I can is nothing,
To her, whose worth, make other worthies nothing;
Shee is alone.

PROTHEUS. Then let her alone.

VALEN. Not for the world: why man, she is mine owne,
930 And I as rich in having such a Jewell
As twenty Seas, if all their sand were pearle,
The water, Nectar, and the Rocks pure gold.
Forgive me, that I doe not dreame on thee,
Because thou seest me doate upon my love:
935 My foolish Rivall that her Father likes
(Onely for his possessions are so huge)
Is gone with her along, and I must after,
For Love (thou know'st is full of jealousie.)

PROTHEUS. But she loves you?

940 *VALEN.* Aye, and we are betroathd: nay more, our mariage howre,
With all the cunning manner of our flight
Determin'd of: how I must climbe her window,
The Ladder made of Cords, and all the means
Plotted, and 'greed on for my happinesse.

945 Good *Protheus* goe with me to my chamber,
In these affaires to aid me with thy counsaile.

PROTHEUS. Goe on before: I shall enquire you forth:
I must unto the Road, to dis-embarque
Some necessaries, that I needs must use,
950 And then Ile presently attend you.

VALEN. Will you make haste? *Exit.*

PROTHEUS. I will.
Even as one heate, another heate expels,
Or as one naile, by strength drives out another.
955 So the remembrance of my former Love
Is by a newer object quite forgotten,
It is mine, or *Valentines* praise?
Her true perfection, or my false transgression?
That makes me reasonlesse, to reason thus?
960 Shee is faire: and so is *Julia* that I love,
(That I did love, for now my love is thaw'd,
Which like a waxen Image 'gainst a fire
Beares no impression of the thing it was.)
Me thinkes my zeale to *Valentine* is cold,
965 And that I love him not as I was wont:
O, but I love his Lady too-too much,
And that's the reason I love him so little.
How shall I doate on her with more advice,
That thus without advice begin to love her?
970 'Tis but her picture I have yet beheld,
And that hath dazel'd my reasons light:
But when I looke on her perfections,
There is no reason, but I shall be blinde.
If I can checke my erring love, I will,
975 If not, to compasse her Ile use my skill. *Exeunt.*

A2S5 Padua. Speed, Launce.

Scena Quinta.

Enter Speed and Launce [and Crabbe].

980 *SPEED.* *Launce*, by mine honesty welcome to *Padua*ⁱ.

LAUNCE. Forsweare not thy selfe, sweet youth, for I am not welcome. I reckon this alwaies, that a man is never undon till hee be hang'd, nor never welcome to a place, till some certaine shot be paid, and the Hostesse say welcome.

985 *SPEED.* Come-on you mad-cap: Ile to the Ale-house with you presently; where, for one shot of five pence, thou shalt have five thousand welcomes: But sirha, how did thy Master part with Madam *Julia*?

LAUNCE. Marry after they cloas'd in earnest, they parted
990 very fairely in jest.

SPEED. But shall she marry him?

LAUNCE. No.

SPEED. How then? shall he marry her?

LAUNCE. No, neither.

995 *SPEED.* What, are they broken?

LAUNCE. No; they are both as whole as a fish.

SPEED. Why then, how stands the matter with them?

LAUNCE. Marry thus, when it stands well with him, it stands well with her.

1000 *SPEED.* What an asse art thou, I understand thee not.

LAUNCE. What a blocke art thou, that thou canst not?
My staffe understands me?

SPEED. What thou saist?

LAUNCE. Aye, and what I do too: looke thee, Ile but leane,
1005 and my staffe understands me.

SPEED. It stands under thee indeed.

LAUNCE. Why, stand-under: and under-stand is all one.

SPEED. But tell me true, wil't be a match?

LAUNCE. Aske my dogge, if he say Aye, it will: if hee say
1010 no, it will: if hee shake his taile, and say nothing, it will.

SPEED. The conclusion is then, that it will.

LAUNCE. Thou shalt never get such a secret from me, but by a parable.

1015 *SPEED.* 'Tis well that I get it so: but *Launce*, how saist thou that that my mastre is become a notable Lover?

LAUNCE. I never knew him otherwise.

SPEED. Then how?

1020 *LAUNCE.* A notable Lubber: as thou reportest him to bee.

SPEED. Why, thou whorson Asse, thou mistak'st me,

LAUNCE. Why Foole, I meant not thee, I meant thy Master.

SPEED. I tell thee, my Master is become a hot Lover.

1025 *LAUNCE.* Why, I tell thee, I care not, though hee burne himselfe in Love. If thou wilt goe with me to the Alehouse: if not, thou art an Hebrew, a Jew, and not worth the name of a Christian.

SPEED. Why?

1030 *LAUNCE.* Because thou hast not so much charity in thee as to goe to the Ale with a Christian: Wilt thou goe?

SPEED. At thy service. *Exeunt.*

A2S6 Milan. *Protheus*

1035 ***Scoena Sexta.***

Enter Protheus solus.

PROTHEUS. To leave my *Julia*; shall I be forsworne?

To love faire *Silvia*; shall I be forsworne?

To wrong my friend, I shall be much forsworne.

1040 And ev'n that Powre which gave me first my oath
Provokes me to this three-fold perjurie.

Love bad mee sweare, and Love bids me for-sweare;

O sweet-suggesting Love, if thou hast sin'd,

Teach me (thy tempted subject) to excuse it.

1045 At first I did adore a twinkling Starre,

But now I worship a celestiall Sunne:

Un-heedfull vowes may heedfully be broken,

And he wants wit, that wants resolved will,

To learne his wit, t'exchange the bad for better;
1050 Fie, fie, unreverend tongue, to call her bad,
Whose sovereignty so oft thou hast preferd,
With twenty thousand soule-confirming oathes.
I cannot leave to love; and yet I doe:
But there I leave to love, where I should love.
1055 *Julia* I loose, and *Valentine* I loose,
If I keepe them, I needs must loose my selfe:
If I loose them, thus finde aye by their losse,
For *Valentine*, my selfe: for *Julia*, *Silvia*.
I to my selfe am deerer then a friend,
1060 For Love is still most precious in it selfe,
And *Silvia* (witnessse heaven that made her faire)
Shewes *Julia* but a swarthy Ethiopie.
I will forget that *Julia* is alive,
Remembring that my Love to her is dead.
1065 And *Valentine* Ile hold an Enemie,
Ayming at *Silvia* as a sweeter friend.
I cannot now prove constant to my selfe,
Without some treachery us'd to *Valentine*.
This night he meaneth with a Corded-ladder
1070 To climbe celestially *Silvia's* chamber window,
My selfe in counsaile his competitor.
Now presently Ile give her father notice
Of their disguising and pretended flight:
Who (all inrag'd) will banish *Valentine*:
1075 For *Thurio* he intends shall wed his daughter,
But *Valentine* being gon, Ile quickly crosse
By some slie trick, blunt *Thurio's* dull proceeding.
Love lend me wings, to make my purpose swift
As thou hast lent me wit, to plot this drift. *Exit.*

1080

A2S7 Verona. *Julia, Lucetta*

Scoena septima.

Enter Julia and Lucetta.

JULIA. Counsaile, *Lucetta*, gentle girle assist me,
1085 And ev'n in kinde love, I doe conjure thee,
Who art the Table wherein all my thoughts
Are visibly Character'd, and engrav'd,
To lesson me, and tell me some good meane

How with my honour I may undertake
1090 A journey to my loving *Protheus*.

LUCETTA. Alas, the way is wearisome and long.

JULIA. A true-devoted Pilgrime is not weary
To measure Kingdomes with his feeble steps,
Much lesse shall she that hath Loves wings to flie,
1095 And when the flight is made to one so deere,
Of such divine perfection as Sir *Protheus*.

LUCETTA. Better forbear, till *Protheus* make returne.

JULIA. Oh, know'st yu not, his looks are my soules food?
Pitty the dearth that I have pined in,
1100 By longing for that food so long a time.
Didst thou but know the inly touch of Love,
Thou wouldst as soone goe kindle fire with snow
As seeke to quench the fire of Love with words.

LUCETTA. I doe not seeke to quench your Loves hot fire,
1105 But qualifie the fires extreame rage,
Lest it should burne above the bounds of reason.

JULIA. The more thou dam'st it up, the more it burnes:
The Current that with gentle murmure glides
(Thou know'st) being stop'd, impatiently doth rage:
1110 But when his faire course is not hindered,
He makes sweet musicke with th' enameld stones,
Giving a gentle kisse to every sedge
He over-taketh in his pilgrimage.
And so by many winding nookes he straies
1115 With willing sport to the wilde Ocean.
Then let me goe, and hinder not my course:
Ile be as patient as a gentle streame,
And make a pastime of each weary step,
Till the last step have brought me to my Love,
1120 And there Ile rest, as after much turmoile
A blessed soule doth in *Elizium*.

LUCETTA. But in what habit will you goe along?

JULIA. Not like a woman, for I would prevent
The loose encounters of lascivious men:
1125 Gentle *Lucetta*, fit me with such weedes
As may beseeme some well reputed Page.

LUCETTA. Why then your Ladiship must cut your haire.

JULIA. No girle, Ile knit it up in silken strings,
With twentie od-conceited true-love knotsⁱⁱ:

1130 To be fantastique, may become a youth
Of greater time then I shall shew to be.

LUCETTA. What fashion (Madam) shall I make your breeches?

JULIA. That fits as well, as tell me (good my Lord)
What compasse will you weare your Farthingale?

1135 Why ev'n what fashion thou best likes (*Lucetta*.)

LUCETTA. You must needs have thē with a cod-peece (Madam)

JULIA. Out, out, (*Lucetta*) that wilbe illfavourd.

LUCETTA. A round hose (Madam) now's not worth a pin
Unlesse you have a cod-peece to stick pins on.

1140 *JULIA*. *Lucetta*, as thou lov'st me let me have
What thou think'st meet, and is most mannerly.
But tell me (wench) how will the world repute me
For undertaking so unstaide a iourney?
I feare me it will make me scandaliz'd.

1145 *LUCETTA*. If you thinke so, then stay at home, and go not.

JULIA. Nay, that I will not.

LUCETTA. Then never dreame on Infamy, but go:
If *Protheus* like your journey, when you come,
No matter who's displeas'd, when you are gone:
1150 I feare me he will scarce be pleas'd with all.

JULIA. That is the least (*Lucetta*) of my feare:
A thousand oathes, an Ocean of his teares,
And instances of infinite of Love,
Warrant me welcome to my *Protheus*.

1155 *LUCETTA*. All these are servants to deceitfull men.

JULIA. Base men, that use them to so base effect;
But truer starres did governe *Protheus* birth,
His words are bonds, his oathes are oracles,
His love sincere, his thoughts immaculate,
1160 His teares, pure messengers, sent from his heart,
His heart, as far from fraud, as heaven from earth.

LUCETTA. Pray heav'n he prove so when you come to him.

JULIA. Now, as thou lov'st me, do him not that wrong,
To beare a hard opinion of his truth:
1165 Onely deserve my love, by loving him,
And presently goe with me to my chamber
To take a note of what I stand in need of,
To furnish me upon my longing journey:
All that is mine I leave at thy dispose,
1170 My goods, my Lands, my reputation,
Onely, in lieu thereof, dispatch me hence:
Come; answere not: but to it presently,
I am impatient of my tarriance. *Exeunt.*

1175 **A3S1 Milan, the Duke's palace.** *Duke, Thurio, Protheus, Valentine,
Launce, Speed.*

Actus Tertius, Scena Prima.

*Enter Duke, Thurio, Protheus, ~~Valentine,~~
~~Launce, Speed.~~*

1180 *DUKE.* Sir *Thurio*, give us leave (I pray) a while,
We have some secrets to confer about.
Now tell me *Protheus*, what's your will with me?

PROTHEUS. My gracious Lord, that which I wold discover,
The Law of friendship bids me to conceale,
1185 But when I call to minde your gracious favours
Done to me (undeserving as I am)
My dutie pricks me on to utter that
Which else, no worldly good should draw from me:
Know (worthy Prince) Sir *Valentine* my friend
1190 This night intends to steale away your daughter:
My selfe am one made privy to the plot.
I know you have determin'd to bestow her
On *Thurio*, whom your gentle daughter hates,
And should she thus be stolne away from you,
1195 It would be much vexation to your age.
Thus (for my duties sake) I rather chose
To crosse my friend in his intended drift,
Then (by concealing it) heap on your head
A pack of sorrowes, which would presse you downe
1200 (Being unprevented) to your timelesse grave.

DUKE. *Protheus*, I thank thee for thine honest care,
Which to requite, command me while I live.

This love of theirs, my selfe have often seene,
Haply when they have judg'd me fast asleepe,
1205 And oftentimes have purpos'd to forbid
Sir *Valentine* her companie, and my Court.
But fearing lest my jealous ayme might erre,
And so (unworthily) disgrace the man
(A rashnesse that I ever yet have shun'd)
1210 I gave him gentle lookes, thereby to finde
That which thy selfe hast now disclos'd to me.
And that thou maist perceive my feare of this,
Knowing that tender youth is soone suggested,
I nightly lodge her in an upper Towre,
1215 The key whereof, my selfe have ever kept:
And thence she cannot be convay'd away.

PROTHEUS. Know (noble Lord) they have devis'd a meane
How he her chamber-window will ascend,
And with a Corded-ladder fetch her downe:
1220 For which, the youthfull Lover now is gone,
And this way comes he with it presently.
Where (if it please you) you may intercept him.
But (good my Lord) doe it so cunningly
That my discovery be not aimed at:
1225 For, love of you, not hate unto my friend,
Hath made me publisher of this pretence.

DUKE. Upon mine Honor, he shall never know
That I had any light from thee of this. *[Enter Valentine wearing a cloak]*

PROTHEUS. Adiew, my Lord, Sir *Valentine* is comming.

1230 *DUKE*. Sir *Valentine*, whether away so fast?

VALEN. Please it your Grace, there is a Messenger
That stayes to beare my Letters to my friends,
And I am going to deliver them.

DUKE. Be they of much import?

1235 *VALEN*. The tenure of them doth but signifie
My health, and happy being at your Court.

DUKE. Nay then no matter: stay with me a while,
I am to breake with thee of some affaires
That touch me neere: wherein thou must be secret.

1240 'Tis not unknown to thee, that I have sought
To match my friend Sir *Thurio*, to my daughter.

VALEN. I know it well (my Lord) and sure the Match
Were rich and honourable: besides, the gentleman
Is full of Vertue, Bounty, Worth, and Qualities
1245 Beseeming such a Wife, as your faire daughter:
Cannot your Grace win her to fancie him?

DUKE. No, trust me, She is peevish, sullen, froward,
Prowd, disobedient, stubborne, lacking duty,
Neither regarding that she is my childe,
1250 Nor fearing me, as if I were her father:
And may I say to thee, this pride of hers
(Upon advice) hath drawne my love from her,
And where I thought the remnant of mine age
Should have beene cherish'd by her child-like dutie,
1255 I now am full resolv'd to take a wife,
And turne her out, to who will take her in:
Then let her beauty be her wedding dowre:
For me, and my possessions she esteemes not.

VALEN. What would your Grace have me to do in this?

1260 DUKE. There is a Lady in Verona heere
Whom I affect: but she is nice, and coy,
And naught esteemes my aged eloquence.
Now therefore would I have thee to my Tutor
(For long agone I have forgot to court,
1265 Besides the fashion of the time is chang'd)
How, and which way I may bestow my selfe
To be regarded in her sun-bright eye.

VALEN. Win her with gifts, if she respect not words,
Dumbe Jewels often in their silent kinde
1270 More then quicke words, doe move a womans minde.

DUKE. But she did scorne a present that I sent her,

VALEN. A woman sometime scorns what best cōtents her.
Send her another: never give her ore,
For scorne at first, makes after-love the more.
1275 If she doe frowne, 'tis not in hate of you,
But rather to beget more love in you.
If she doe chide, 'tis not to have you gone,
For why, the fooles are mad, if left alone.
Take no repulse, what ever she doth say,
1280 For, get you gon, she doth not meane away.
Flatter, and praise, commend, extoll their graces:

Though nere so blacke, say they have Angells faces,
That man that hath a tongue, I say is no man,
If with his tongue he cannot win a woman.

1285 *DUKE.* But she I meane, is promis'd by her friends
Unto a youthfull Gentleman of worth,
And kept severely from resort of men,
That no man hath accesse by day to her.

VALEN. Why then I would resort to her by night.

1290 *DUKE.* Aye, but the doores be lockt, and keyes kept safe,
That no man hath recourse to her by night.

VALEN. What letts but one may enter at her window?

DUKE. Her chamber is aloft, far from the ground,
And built so shelving, that one cannot climbe it
1295 Without apparant hazard of his life.

VALEN. Why then a Ladder quaintly made of Cords
To cast up, with a paire of anchoring hookes,
Would serve to scale another *Hero's* towre,
So bold *Leander* would adventure it.

1300 *DUKE.* Now as thou art a Gentleman of blood
Advise me, where I may have such a Ladder.

VALEN. When would you use it? pray sir, tell me that.

DUKE. This very night; for Love is like a childe
That longs for every thing that he can come by.

1305 *VALEN.* By seaven a clock, ile get you such a Ladder.

DUKE. But harke thee: I will goe to her alone,
How shall I best convey the Ladder thither?

VALEN. It will be light (my Lord) that you may beare it
Under a cloake, that is of any length.

1310 *DUKE.* A cloake as long as thine will serve the turne?

VALEN. Aye my good Lord.

DUKE. Then let me see thy cloake,
Ile get me one of such another length.

VALEN. Why any cloake will serve the turn (my Lord)
1315 *[Valentine takes off cloak, Duke holds cloak, scroll and ladder]*

DUKE. How shall I fashion me to weare a cloake?
I pray thee let me feele thy cloake upon me.
What Letter is this same? what's here? to *Silvia*?
And heere an Engine fit for my proceeding,
1320 Ile be so bold to breake the seale for once.
My thoughts do harbour with my Silvia nightly,
And slaves they are to me, that send them flying.
Oh, could their Master come, and goe as lightly,
Himselfe would lodge where (senceles) they are lying.
1325 *My Herald Thoughts, in thy pure bosome rest-them,*
While I (their King) that thither them importune
Doe curse the grace, that with such grace hath blest them,
Because my selfe doe want my servants fortune.
I curse my selfe, for they are sent by me,
1330 *That they should harbour where their Lord should be.*

What's here? *Silvia*, *this night I will enfranchise thee.*
'Tis so: and heere's the Ladder for the purpose.
Why *Phaeton* (for thou art *Merops sonne*)
1335 Wilt thou aspire to guide the heavenly Car?
And with thy daring folly burne the world?
Wilt thou reach stars, because they shine on thee?
Goe base Intruder, over-weening Slave,
Bestow thy fawning smiles on equall mates,
1340 And thinke my patience, (more then thy desert)
Is priviledge for thy departure hence.
Thanke me for this, more then for all the favors
Which (all too-much) I have bestowed on thee.
But if thou linger in my Territories
1345 Longer then swiftest expedition
Will give thee time to leave our royall Court,
By heaven, my wrath shall farre exceed the love
I ever bore my daughter, or thy selfe.
Be gone, I will not heare thy vaine excuse,
1350 But as thou lov'st thy life, make speed from hence. *[Exit]*

VALEN. And why not death, rather then living torment?
To die, is to be banisht from my selfe,
And *Silvia* is my selfe: banish'd from her
Is selfe from selfe. A deadly banishment:
1355 What light, is light, if *Silvia* be not seene?
What joy is joy, if *Silvia* be not by?
Unlesse it be to thinke that she is by

And feed upon the shadow of perfection.
Except I be by *Silvia* in the night,
1360 There is no musicke in the Nightingale.
Unlesse I looke on *Silvia* in the day,
There is no day for me to looke upon.
Shee is my essence, and I leave to be;
If I be not by her faire influence
1365 Foster'd, illumin'd, cherish'd, kept alive.
I flie not death, to flie his deadly doome,
Tarry I heere, I but attend on death,
But flie I hence, I flie away from life. [Enter *Protheus*, *Launce*]

PROTHEUS. Run (boy) run, run, and seeke him out.

1370 *LAUNCE*. So-hough, Soa hough---

PROTHEUS. What seest thou?

LAUNCE. Him we goe to finde,
There's not a haire on's head, but t'is a *Valentine*.

PROTHEUS. *Valentine*?

1375 *VALEN*. No.

PROTHEUS. Who then? his Spirit?

VALEN. Neither,

PROTHEUS. What then?

VALEN. Nothing.

1380 *LAUNCE*. Can nothing speake? Master, shall I strike?

PROTHEUS. Who wouldst thou strike?

LAUNCE. Nothing.

PROTHEUS. Villaine, forbear.

LAUNCE. Why Sir, Ile strike nothing: I pray you.

1385 *PROTHEUS*. Sirha, I say forbear: friend *Valentine*, a word.

VALEN. My eares are stopt, & cannot hear good newes,
So much of bad already hath possest them.

PROTHEUS. Then in dumbe silence will I bury mine,
For they are harsh, un-tuneable, and bad.

1390 *VALEN*. Is *Silvia* dead?

PROTHEUS. No, *Valentine*.

VALEN. No *Valentine* indeed, for sacred *Silvia*,
Hath she forsworne me?

PROTHEUS. No, *Valentine*.

1395 VALEN. No *Valentine*, if *Silvia* have forsworne me.
What is your newes?

LAUNCE. Sir, there is a proclamation, yt you are vanished.

PROTHEUS. That thou art banish'd: oh that's the newes,
From hence, from *Silvia*, and from me thy friend.

1400 VALEN. Oh, I have fed upon this woe already,
And now excesse of it will make me surfet.
Doth *Silvia* know that I am banish'd?

PROTHEUS. Aye, aye: and she hath offered to the doome
(Which un-reverst stands in effectuall force)

1405 A Sea of melting pearle, which some call teares;
Those at her fathers churlish feete she tenderd,
With them upon her knees, her humble selfe,
Wringing her hands, whose whitenes so became them,
As if but now they waxed pale for woe:

1410 But neither bended knees, pure hands held up,
Sad sighes, deepe grones, nor silver-shedding teares
Could penetrate her uncompassionate Sire;
But *Valentine*, if he be tane, must die.

Besides, her intercession chaf'd him so,
1415 When she for thy repeale was suppliant,
That to close prison he commanded her,
With many bitter threats of biding there.

VALEN. No more: unles the next word that thou speak'st
Have some malignant power upon my life:

1420 If so: I pray thee breath it in mine eare,
As ending Antheme of my endlesse dolor.

PROTHEUS. Cease to lament for that thou canst not helpe,
And study helpe for that which thou lament'st,
Time is the Nurse, and breeder of all good;

1425 Here, if thou stay, thou canst not see thy love:
Besides, thy staying will abridge thy life:
Hope is a lovers staffe, walke hence with that
And manage it, against despairing thoughts:
Thy letters may be here, though thou art hence,
1430 Which, being writ to me, shall be deliver'd

Even in the milke-white bosome of thy Love.
The time now serves not to expostulate,
Come, Ile convey thee through the City-gate.
And ere I part with thee, confer at large
1435 Of all that may concerne thy Love-affaires:
As thou lov'st *Silvia* (though not for thy selfe)
Regard thy danger, and along with me.

VALEN. I pray thee *Launce*, and if thou seest my Boy
Bid him make haste, and meet me at the North-gate.

1440 *PROTHEUS.* Goe sirha, finde him out: Come *Valentine*.

VALEN. Oh my deere *Silvia*; haplesse *Valentine*. *[Exit Protheus,*
Valentine]

LAUNCE. I am but a foole, looke you, and yet I have
the wit to thinke my Master is a kinde of a knave: but
1445 that's all one, if he be but one knave: He lives not now
that knowes me to be in love, yet I am in love, but a
Teeme of horse shall not plucke that from me: nor who
'tis I love: and yet 'tis a woman; but what woman, I
will not tell my selfe: and yet 'tis a Milke-maid: yet 'tis
1450 not a maid: for shee hath had Gossips: yet 'tis a maid,
for she is her Masters maid, and serves for wages. Shee
hath more qualities then a Water-Spaniell, which is
much in a bare Christian: Heere is the Cate-log of her
Condition. *Inprimis.* Shee can fetch and carry: why
1455 a horse can doe no more; nay, a horse cannot fetch, but
onely carry, therefore is shee better then a Jade. *Item.*
Shee can milke, looke you, a sweet vertue in a maid with
cleane hands.

[Enter Speed]

1460 *SPEED.* How now Signior *Launce*? what newes with
your Mastership?

LAUNCE. With my Mastership? why, it is at Sea:

SPEED. Well, your old vice still: mistake the word: what
newes then in your paper?

1465 *LAUNCE.* The black'st newes that ever thou heard'st.

SPEED. Why man? how blacke?

LAUNCE. Why, as blacke as Inke.

SPEED. Let me read them?

LAUNCE. Fie on thee Jolt-head, thou canst not read.

1470 *SPEED.* Thou lyest: I can.

LAUNCE. I will try thee: tell me this: who begot thee?

SPEED. Marry, the son of my Grand-father.

LAUNCE. Oh illiterate loyterer; it was the sonne of thy Grand-mother: this proves that thou canst not read.

1475 *SPEED.* Come foole, come: try me in thy paper.

LAUNCE. There: and Saint *Nicholas* be thy speed.

SPEED. Inprimis she can milke.

LAUNCE. Aye that she can.

SPEED. Item, she brewes good Ale.

1480 *LAUNCE.* And thereof comes the proverbe: (*Blessing of your heart, you brew good Ale.*)

SPEED. Item, she can sowe.

LAUNCE. That's as much as to say (*Can she so?*)

SPEED. Item she can knit.

1485 *LAUNCE.* What neede a man care for a stock with a wench,
When she can knit him a stocke?

SPEED. Item, she can wash and scoure.

LAUNCE. A speciall vertue: for then shee neede not be wash'd, and scowr'd.

1490 *SPEED.* Item, she can spin.

LAUNCE. Then may I set the world on wheelles, when she can spin for her living.

SPEED. Item, she hath many namelesse vertues.

1495 *LAUNCE.* That's as much as to say *Bastard-vertues*: that
indeede know not their fathers; and therefore have no names.

SPEED. Here follow her vices.

LAUNCE. Close at the heeles of her vertues.

1500 *SPEED.* Item, shee is not to be fasting in respect of her
breath.

LAUNCE. Well: that fault may be mended with a break-
fast: read on.

SPEED. Item, she hath a sweet mouth.

LAUNCE. That makes amends for her soure breath.

1505 *SPEED.* Item, she doth talke in her sleepe.

LAUNCE. It's no matter for that; so shee sleepe not in her
talke.

SPEED. Item, she is slow in words.

1510 *LAUNCE.* Oh villaine, that set this downe among her vices;
To be slow in words, is a womans onely vertue:
I pray thee out with't, and place it for her chiefe vertue.

SPEED. Item, she is proud.

LAUNCE. Out with that too:
It was *Eves* legacie, and cannot be t'ane from her.

1515 *SPEED.* Item, she hath no teeth.

LAUNCE. I care not for that neither: because I love crusts.

SPEED. Item, she is curst.

LAUNCE. Well: the best is, she hath no teeth to bite.

SPEED. Item, she will often praise her liquor.

1520 *LAUNCE.* If her liquor be good, she shall: if she will not,
I will; for good things should be praised.

SPEED. Item, she is too liberall.

1525 *LAUNCE.* Of her tongue she cannot; for that's writ downe
she is slow of: of her purse, shee shall not, for that ile
keepe shut: Now, of another thing shee may, and that
cannot I helpe. Well, proceede.

SPEED. Item, shee hath more haire then wit, and more
faults then haire, and more wealth then faults.

1530 *LAUNCE.* Stop there: Ile have her: she was mine, and not
mine, twice or thrice in that last Article: rehearse that
once more.

SPEED. Item, she hath more haire then wit.

LAUNCE. More haire then wit: it may be ile prove it: The
cover of the salt, hides the salt, and therefore it is more
1535 then the salt; the haire that covers the wit, is more
then the wit; for the greater hides the lesse: What's
next?

SPEED. And more faults then haire.

LAUNCE. That's monstrous: oh that that were out.

1540 SPEED. And more wealth then faults.

LAUNCE. Why that word makes the faults gracious:
Well, ile have her: and if it be a match, as nothing is
impossible.

SPEED. What then?

1545 LAUNCE. Why then, will I tell thee, that thy Master staies
for thee at the *North gate*.

SPEED. For me?

LAUNCE. For thee? Aye, who art thou? he hath staid for a better
man then thee.

1550 SPEED. And must I goe to him?

LAUNCE. Thou must run to him; for thou hast staid so long,
that going will scarce serve the turne.

SPEED. Why didst not tell me sooner? 'pox of your love
Letters.

1555 LAUNCE. Now will he be swing'd for reading my Letter;
An unmannerly slave, that will thrust himselfe into secrets:
Ile after, to rejoyce in the boyes correctiō. *Exeunt.*

A3S2 Milan, the Duke's palace. *Duke, Thurio, Protheus*

1560 *Scena Secunda.*

Enter Duke, Thurio, Protheus.

DUKE. Sir *Thurio*, feare not, but that she will love you
Now *Valentine* is banish'd from her sight.

THURIO. Since his exile she hath despis'd me most,
1565 Forsworne my company, and rail'd at me,
That I am desperate of obtaining her.

DUKE. This weake impresse of Love, is as a figure
Trenched in ice, which with an houres heate
Dissolves to water, and doth loose his forme.
1570 A little time will melt her frozen thoughts,
And worthlesse *Valentine* shall be forgot.
How now sir *Protheus*, is your countriman
(According to our Proclamation) gon?
PROTHEUS. Gon, my good Lord.
1575 DUKE. My daughter takes his going grievously?
PROTHEUS. A little time (my Lord) will kill that grieffe.
DUKE. So I beleeeve: but *Thurio* thinkes not so:
Protheus, the good conceit I hold of thee,
(For thou hast showne some signe of good desert)
1580 Makes me the better to confer with thee.
PROTHEUS. Longer then I prove loyall to your Grace,
Let me not live, to looke upon your Grace.
DUKE. Thou know'st how willingly, I would effect
The match betweene Sir *Thurio*, and my daughter?
1585 PROTHEUS. I doe my Lord.
DUKE. And also, I thinke, thou art not ignorant
How she opposes her against my will?
PROTHEUS. She did my Lord, when *Valentine* was here.
DUKE. Aye, and perversly, she perseveres so:
1590 What might we doe to make the girle forget
The love of *Valentine*, and love sir *Thurio*?
PROTHEUS. The best way is, to slander *Valentine*,
With falsehood, cowardize, and poore discent:
Three things, that women highly hold in hate.
1595 DUKE. Aye, but she'll thinke, that it is spoke in hate.
PROTHEUS. Aye, if his enemy deliver it.
Therefore it must with circumstance be spoken
By one, whom she esteemeth as his friend.
DUKE. Then you must undertake to slander him.
1600 PROTHEUS. And that (my Lord) I shall be loath to doe:
'Tis an ill office for a Gentleman,
Especially against his very friend.

DUKE. Where your good word cannot advantage him,
Your slander never can endamage him;
1605 Therefore the office is indifferent,
Being intreated to it by your friend.

PROTHEUS. You have prevail'd (my Lord) if I can doe it
By ought that I can speake in his dispraise,
She shall not long continue love to him:
1610 But say this weede her love from *Valentine*,
It followes not that she will love sir *Thurio*.

THURIO. Therefore, as you unwind her love from him;
Least it should ravell, and be good to none,
You must provide to bottome it on me:
1615 Which must be done, by praising me as much
As you, in worth dispraise, sir *Valentine*.

DUKE. And *Protheus*, we dare trust you in this kinde,
Because we know (on *Valentines* report)
You are already loves firme votary,
1620 And cannot soone revolt, and change your minde.
Upon this warrant, shall you have accesse,
Where you, with *Silvia*, may conferre at large.
For she is lumpish, heavy, mellancholly,
And (for your friends sake) will be glad of you;
1625 Where you may temper her, by your perswasion,
To hate yong *Valentine*, and love my friend.

PROTHEUS. As much as I can doe, I will effect:
But you sir *Thurio*, are not sharpe enough:
You must lay Lime, to tangle her desires
1630 By walefull Sonnets, whose composed Rimes
Should be full fraught with serviceable vowes.

DUKE. Aye, much is the force of heaven-bred Poesie.

PROTHEUS. Say that upon the altar of her beauty
You sacrifice your teares, your sighes, your heart:
1635 Write till your inke be dry: and with your teares
Moist it againe: and frame some feeling line,
That may discover such integrity:
For *Orpheus* Lute, was strung with Poets sinewes,
Whose golden touch could soften steele and stones;
1640 Make Tygers tame, and huge *Leviathans*
Forsake unsounded deepes, to dance on Sands.
After your dire-lamenting Elegies,

Visit by night your Ladies chamber-window
With some sweet Consort; To their Instruments
1645 Tune a deploring dumpe: the nights dead silence
Will well become such sweet complaining grievance:
This, or else nothing, will inherit her.

DUKE. This discipline, shoves thou hast bin in love.

THURIO. And thy advice, this night, ile put in practise:
1650 Therefore, sweet *Protheus*, my direction-giver,
Let us into the City presently
To sort some Gentlemen, well skil'd in Musicke.
I have a Sonnet, that will serve the turne
To give the on-set to thy good advise.

1655 *DUKE.* About it Gentlemen.

PROTHEUS. We'll wait upon your Grace, till after Supper,
And afterward determine our proceedings.

DUKE. Even now about it, I will pardon you. *Exeunt.*

1660 ***A4S1 Road from Milano. Valentine, Speed, Outlaws.***

Actus Quartus. Scoena Prima.

Enter Valentine, Speed, and certaine Out-lawes.

1OUTLAW. Fellowes, stand fast: I see a passenger.

2OUTLAW. If there be ten, shrink not, but down with 'em.

1665 *3OUTLAW.* Stand sir, and throw us that you have about 'ye.
If not: we'll make you sit, and rifle you.

SPEED. Sir we are undone; these are the Villaines
That all the Travailers doe feare so much.

VALEN. My friends.

1670 *1OUTLAW.* That's not so, sir: we are your enemies.

2OUTLAW. Peace: we'll heare him.

3OUTLAW. Aye by my beard will we: for he is a proper man.

VALEN. Then know that I have little wealth to loose;
A man I am, cross'd with adversitie:
1675 My riches, are these poore habiliments,
Of which, if you should here disfurnish me,
You take the sum and substance that I have.

2OUTLAW. Whether travell you?

VALEN. To *Verona*.

1680 1OUTLAW. Whence came you?

VALEN. From *Millaine*.

3OUTLAW. Have you long sojourn'd there?

VALEN. Some sixteene moneths, and longer might have staid,
If crooked fortune had not thwarted me.

1685 1OUTLAW. What, were you banish'd thence?

VALEN. I was.

2OUTLAW. For what offence?

VALEN. For that which now torments me to rehearse;
I kil'd a man, whose death I much repent,
1690 But yet I slew him manfully, in fight,
Without false vantage, or base treachery.

1OUTLAW. Why nere repent it, if it were done so;
But were you banisht for so small a fault?

VALEN. I was, and held me glad of such a doome.

1695 2OUTLAW. Have you the Tongues?

VALEN. My youthfull travaile, therein made me happy,
Or else I often had beene often miserable.

3OUTLAW. By the bare scalpe of *Robin Hoods* fat Fryer,
This fellow were a King, for our wilde faction.

1700 1OUTLAW. We'll have him: Sirs, a word.

SPEED. Master, be one of them:
It's an honourable kinde of theevery.

VALEN. Peace villaine.

2OUTLAW. Tell us this: have you any thing to take to?

1705 VALEN. Nothing but my fortune.

3OUTLAW. Know then, that some of us are Gentlemen,
Such as the fury of ungovern'd youth
Thrust from the company of awfull men.
My selfe was from *Verona* banished,
1710 For practising to steale away a Lady,
And heire and Neece, alide unto the Duke.

2OUTLAW. And I from *Mantua*, for a Gentleman,
Who, in my moode, I stab'd unto the heart.

1OUTLAW. And I, for such like petty crimes as these.

1715 But to the purpose: for we cite our faults,
That they may hold excus'd our lawlesse lives;
And partly seeing you are beautifide
With goodly shape; and by your owne report,
A Linguist, and a man of such perfection,
1720 As we doe in our quality much want.

2OUTLAW. Indeede because you are a banish'd man,
Therefore, above the rest, we parley to you:
Are you content to be our Generall?
To make a vertue of necessity,
1725 And live as we doe in this wilderness?

3OUTLAW. What saist thou? wilt thou be of our consort?
Say Aye, and be the captaine of us all:
We'll doe thee homage, and be rul'd by thee,
Love thee, as our Commander, and our King.

1730 1OUTLAW. But if thou scorne our curtesie, thou dyest.

2OUTLAW. Thou shalt not live, to brag what we have of-

VALEN. I take your offer, and will live with you, fer'd.
Provided that you do no outrages
On silly women, or poore passengers.

1735 3OUTLAW. No, we detest such vile base practises.
Come, goe with us, we'll bring thee to our Crewes,
And show thee all the Treasure we have got;
Which, with our selves, all rest at thy dispose. *Exeunt.*

1740 **A4S2 Milan. Outside the Duke's palace and Host's inn.** *Protheus,*
Thurio, Julia, Host, Silvia, NPC Musitian

Scoena Secunda.

Enter Protheus, Thurio, Musitian [below].

Julia, Host. Silvia [aloft]

1745 *PROTHEUS.* Already have I bin false to *Valentine*,
And now I must be as unjust to *Thurio*,
Under the colour of commending him,
I have accesse my owne love to prefer.
But *Silvia* is too faire, too true, too holy,

1750 To be corrupted with my worthlesse guifts;
When I protest true loyalty to her,
She twits me with my falsehood to my friend;
When to her beauty I commend my vowes,
She bids me thinke how I have bin forsworne
1755 In breaking faith with *Julia*, whom I lov'd;
And notwithstanding all her sodaine quips,
The least whereof would quell a lovers hope:
Yet (Spaniel-like) the more she spurnes my love,
The more it growes, and fawneth on her still;
1760 But here comes *Thurio*; now must we to her window,
And give some evening Musique to her eare.

THURIO. How now, sir *Protheus*, are you crept before us?

PROTHEUS. Aye gentle *Thurio*, for you know that love
Will creepe in service, where it cannot goe.

1765 *THURIO*. Aye, but I hope, Sir, that you love not here.

PROTHEUS. Sir, but I doe: or else I would be hence.

THURIO. Who, *Silvia*?

PROTHEUS. Aye, *Silvia*, for your sake.

THURIO. I thanke you for your owne: Now Gentlemen
1770 Let's tune: and too it lustily a while.

HOST. Now, my yong guest; me thinks your' allycholly;
I pray you why is it?

JULIA. Marry (mine *Host*) because I cannot be merry.

HOST. Come, we'll have you merry: ile bring you where
1775 you shall heare Musique, and see the Gentleman that
you ask'd for.

JULIA. But shall I heare him speake.

HOST. Aye that you shall.

JULIA. That will be Musique.

1780 *HOST*. Harke, harke.

JULIA. Is he among these?

HOST. Aye: but peace, let's heare'm.

PROTEUS. *Song*.

1785 *Who is Silvia? what is she?*
That all our Swaines commend her?
Holy, faire, and wise is she,
The heaven such grace did lend her,
that she might admired be.

1790 *Is she kinde as she is faire?*
For beauty lives with kindnesse:
Love doth to her eyes repaire,
To helpe him of his blindnesse:
And being help'd, inhabits there.

1795 *Then to Silvia, let us sing,*
That Silvia is excelling;
She excels each mortall thing
Upon the dull earth dwelling.
To her let us Garlands bring.

1800 *HOST.* How now? are you sadder then you were before;
How doe you, man? the Musicke likes you not.
JULIA. You mistake: the Musitian likes me not.
HOST. Why, my pretty youth?
JULIA. He plaies false (father.)

1805 *HOST.* How, out of tune on the strings.
JULIA. Not so: but yet
So false that he grieves my very heart-strings.
HOST. You have a quicke eare.
JULIA. Aye, I would I were deafe: it makes me have a slow heart.

1810 *HOST.* I perceive you delight not in Musique.
JULIA. Not a whit, when it jars so.
HOST. Harke, what fine change is in the Musique.
JULIA. Aye: that change is the spight.
HOST. You would have them alwaies play but one thing.

1815 *JULIA.* I would alwaies have one play but one thing.
But Host, doth this Sir *Protheus*, that we talke on,
Often resort unto this Gentlewoman?
HOST. I tell you what *Launce* his man told me,
He lov'd her out of all nicke.

1820 *JULIA*. Where is *Launce*?

HOST. Gone to seeke his dog, which to morrow, by his
Masters command, hee must carry for a present to his
Lady.

JULIA. Peace, stand aside, the company parts.

1825 *PROTHEUS*. Sir *Thurio*, feare not you, I will so pleade,
That you shall say, my cunning drift excels.

THURIO. Where meete we?

PROTHEUS. At Saint *Gregories* well.

THURIO. Farewell.

1830 *PROTHEUS*. Madam: good ev'n to your Ladiship.

SILVIA. I thanke you for your Musique (Gentlemen)
Who is that that spake?

PROTHEUS. One (Lady) if you knew his pure hearts truth,
You would quickly learne to know him by his voice.

1835 *SILVIA*. Sir *Protheus*, as I take it.

PROTHEUS. Sir *Protheus* (gentle Lady) and your Servant.

SILVIA. What's your will?

PROTHEUS. That I may compasse yours.

SILVIA. You have your wish: my will is even this,

1840 That presently you hie you home to bed:
Thou subtile, perjur'd, false, disloyall man:
Think'st thou I am so shallow, so conceitlesse,
To be seduced by thy flattery,
That has't deceiv'd so many with thy vowes?

1845 Returne, returne and make thy love amends:
For me (by this pale queene of night I sweare)
I am so farre from granting thy request,
That I despise thee, for thy wrongfull suite;
And by and by intend to chide my selfe,

1850 Even for this time I spend in talking to thee.

PROTHEUS. I grant (sweet love) that I did love a Lady,
But she is dead.

JULIA. 'Twere false, if I should speake it;
For I am sure she is not buried.

1855 *SILVIA*. Say that she be: yet *Valentine* thy friend
Survives; to whom (thy selfe art witnesse)
I am betroth'd; and art thou not asham'd
To wrong him, with thy importunacy?

PROTHEUS. I likewise heare that *Valentine* is dead.

1860 *SILVIA*. And so suppose am I; for in her grave
Assure thy selfe, my love is buried.

PROTHEUS. Sweet Lady, let me rake it from the earth.

SILVIA. Goe to thy Ladies grave and call hers thence,
Or at the least, in hers, sepulcher thine.

1865 *JULIA*. He heard not that.

PROTHEUS. Madam: if your heart be so obdurate:
Vouchsafe me yet your Picture for my love,
The Picture that is hanging in your chamber:
To that ile speake, to that ile sigh and weepe:
1870 For since the substance of your perfect selfe
Is else devoted, I am but a shadow;
And to your shadow, will I make true love.

JULIA. If 'twere a substance you would sure deceive it,
And make it but a shadow, as I am.

1875 *SILVIA*. I am very loath to be your Idoll Sir;
But, since your falsehood shall become you well
To worship shadowes, and adore false shapes,
Send to me in the morning, and ile send it:
And so, good rest.

1880 *PROTHEUS*. As wretches have ore-night
That wait for execution in the morne.

JULIA. Host, will you goe?

HOST. By my hallidome, I was fast asleepe.

JULIA. Pray you, where lies Sir *Protheus*?

1885 *HOST*. Marry, at my house:
Trust me, I thinke 'tis almost day.

JULIA. Not so: but it hath bin the longest night
That ere I watch'd, and the most heaviest. *Exeunt*

1890 **A4S3 Milan. outside the Duke's palace.** *Eglamore, Silvia*

Scoena Tertia.

Enter Eglamore, Silvia [aloft?].

EGLAMORE. This is the houre that Madam *Silvia*
Entreated me to call, and know her minde:
1895 Ther's some great matter she'ld employ me in.
Madam, Madam.

SILVIA. Who cal's?

EGLAMORE. Your servant, and your friend;
One that attends your Ladiships command.

1900 *SILVIA.* Sir *Eglamore*, a thousand times good morrow.

EGLAMORE. As many (worthy Lady) to your selfe:
According to your Ladiships impose,
I am thus early come, to know what service
It is your pleasure to command me in.

1905 *SILVIA.* Oh *Eglamoure*, thou art a Gentleman:
Thinke not I flatter (for I sweare I doe not)
Valiant, wise, remorse-full, well accomplish'd.
Thou art not ignorant what deere good will
I beare unto the banish'd *Valentine*:

1910 Nor how my father would enforce me marry
Vaine *Thurio* (whom my very soule abhor'd.)
Thy selfe hast lov'd, and I have heard thee say
No grieve did ever come so neere thy heart,
As when thy Lady, and thy true-love dide,

1915 Upon whose Grave thou vow'dst pure chastitie:
Sir Eglamoure: I would to *Valentine*
To *Mantua*, where I heare, he makes aboard;
And for the waies are dangerous to passe,
I doe desire thy worthy company,

1920 Upon whose faith and honor, I repose.
Urge not my fathers anger (*Eglamoure*)
But thinke upon my grieve (a Ladies grieve)
And on the justice of my flying hence,
To keepe me from a most unholy match,
1925 Which heaven and fortune still rewards with plagues.
I doe desire thee, even from a heart
As full of sorrowes, as the Sea of sands,
To beare me company, and goe with me:

1930 If not, to hide what I have said to thee,
That I may venture to depart alone.

EGLAMORE. Madam, I pittie much your grievances,
Which, since I know they vertuously are plac'd,
I give consent to goe along with you,
Wreaking as little what betideth me,
1935 As much, I wish all good befortune you.
When will you goe?

SILVIA. This evening comming.

EGLAMORE. Where shall I meete you?

SILVIA. At *Frier Patrickes* Cell,
1940 Where I intend holy Confession.

EGLAMORE. I will not faile your Ladiship:
Good morrow (gentle Lady.)

SILVIA. Good morrow, kinde Sir *Eglamoure*. *Exeunt.*

1945 **A4S4 Milan, the Duke's palace.** *Launce, Protheus, Julia, Silvia.*

Scena Quarta.

*Enter Launce [downstage] and Crabbe, Protheus, Julia,
Silvia.*

LAUNCE. When a mans servant shall play the Curre with
1950 him (looke you) it goes hard: one that I brought up of
a puppy: one that I sav'd from drowning, when three or
foure of his blinde brothers and sisters went to it: I have
taught him (even as one would say precisely, thus I
would teach a dog) I was sent to deliver him, as a pre-
1955 sent to Mistris *Silvia*, from my Master; and I came no
sooner into the dyning-chamber, but he steps me to her
Trencher, and steales her Capons-leg: O, 'tis a foule
thing, when a Cur cannot keepe himselfe in all companies:
I would have (as one should say) one that takes upon
1960 him to be a dog indeede, to be, as it were, a dog at all
things. If I had not had more wit then he, to take a fault
upon me that he did, I thinke verily hee had bin hang'd
for't: sure as I live he had suffer'd for't: you shall judge:
Hee thrusts me himselfe into the company of three or
1965 foure gentleman-like-dogs, under the Dukes table: hee
had not bin there (blesse the marke) a pissing while, but

all the chamber smelt him: out with the dog (saies one)
what cur is that (saies another) whip him out (saies the
third) hang him up (saies the Duke.) I having bin
1970 acquainted with the smell before, knew it was Crab;
and goes me to the fellow that whips the dogges: friend
(quoth I) you meane to whip the dog: Aye marry doe I
(quoth he) you doe him the more wrong (quoth I) 'twas
I did the thing you wot of: he makes me no more adoe,
1975 but whips me out of the chamber: how many Masters
would doe this for his Servant? nay, ile be sworne I have
sat in the stockes, for puddings he hath stolne, otherwise
he had bin executed: I have stood on the Pillorie for
Geese he hath kil'd, otherwise he had sufferd for't: thou
1980 think'st not of this now: nay, I remember the tricke you
serv'd me, when I tooke my leave of Madam *Silvia*: did
not I bid thee still marke me, and doe as I do; when did'st
thou see me heave up my leg, and make water against a
Gentlewomans farthingale? did'st thou ever see me doe
1985 such a tricke?

PROTHEUS. *Sebastian* is thy name: I like thee well,
And will imploy thee in some service presently. *[they come downstage]*

JULIA. In what you please, ile doe what I can.

PROTHEUS. I hope thou wilt.
1990 How now you whor-son pezant,
Where have you bin these two dayes loytering?

LAUNCE. Marry Sir, I carried Mistris *Silvia* the dogge you
bad me.

PROTHEUS. And what saies she to my little Jewell?

1995 *LAUNCE*. Marry she saies your dog was a cur, and tels you
currish thanks is good enough for such a present.

PROTHEUS. But she receiv'd my dog?

LAUNCE. No indeede did she not:
Here have I brought him backe againe.

2000 *PROTHEUS*. What, didst thou offer her this from me?

LAUNCE. Aye Sir, the other Squirrill was stolne from me
By the Hangmans boyes in the market place,
And then I offer'd her mine owne, who is a dog
As big as ten of yours, & therefore the guift the greater.

2005 *PROTHEUS*. Goe, get thee hence, and finde my dog againe,
Or nere returne againe into my sight.

Away, I say: stayest thou to vexe me here;

A Slave, that still an end, turnes me to shame: *[Exit Launce]*

Sebastian, I have entertained thee,

2010 Partly that I have neede of such a youth,
That can with some discretion doe my businesse:

For 'tis no trusting to yond foolish Lowt;

But chiefly, for thy face, and thy behaviour,

Which (if my Augury deceive me not)

2015 Witnesse good bringing up, fortune, and truth:
Therefore know thee, for this I entertaine thee.

Go presently, and take this Ring with thee,

Deliver it to Madam *Silvia*;

She lov'd me well, deliver'd it to me.

2020 *JULIA*. It seemes you lov'd not her, not leave her token:
She is dead belike?

PROTHEUS. Not so: I thinke she lives.

JULIA. Alas.

PROTHEUS. Why do'st thou cry alas?

2025 *JULIA*. I cannot choose but pitty her.

PROTHEUS. Wherefore should'st thou pitty her?

JULIA. Because, me thinkes that she lov'd you as well

As you doe love your Lady *Silvia*:

She dreames on him, that has forgot her love,

2030 You doate on her, that cares not for your love.

'Tis pitty Love, should be so contrary:

And thinking on it, makes me cry alas.

PROTHEUS. Well: give her that Ring, and therewithall

This Letter: that's her chamber: Tell my Lady,

2035 I claime the promise for her heavenly Picture:

Your message done, hye home unto my chamber,

Where thou shalt finde me sad, and solitarie. *[exit]*

Enter Silvia

JULIA. How many women would doe such a message?

2040 Alas poore *Protheus*, thou hast entertain'd

A Foxe, to be the Shepheard of thy Lambs;

Alas, poore foole, why doe I pitty him

That with his very heart despiseth me?
Because he loves her, he despiseth me,
2045 Because I love him, I must pittie him.
This Ring I gave him, when he parted from me,
To binde him to remember my good will:
And now am I (unhappy Messenger)
To plead for that, which I would not obtaine;
2050 To carry that, which I would have refus'd;
To praise his faith, which I would have disprais'd.
I am my Masters true confirmed Love,
But cannot be true servant to my Master,
Unlesse I prove false traitor to my selfe.
2055 Yet will I woe for him, but yet so coldly,
As (heaven it knowes) I would not have him speed.
Gentlewoman, good day: I pray you be my meane
To bring me where to speake with Madam *Silvia*.

SILVIA. What would you with her, if that I be she?

2060 *JULIA*. If you be she, I doe intreat your patience
To heare me speake the message I am sent on.

SILVIA. From whom?

JULIA. From my Master, Sir *Protheus*, Madam.

SILVIA. Oh: he sends you for a Picture?

2065 *JULIA*. Aye, Madam.

SILVIA. *Ursula*, bring my Picture there,
Goe, give your Master this: tell him from me,
One *Julia*, that his changing thoughts forget
Would better fit his Chamber, then this Shadow.

2070 *JULIA*. Madam, please you peruse this Letter;
Pardon me (Madam) I have unadvis'd
Deliver'd you a paper that I should not;
This is the Letter to your Ladiship.

SILVIA. I pray thee let me looke on that againe.

2075 *JULIA*. It may not be: good Madam pardon me.

SILVIA. There, hold:

I will not looke upon your Masters lines:
I know they are stuft with protestations,
And full of new-found oathes, which he will breake
2080 As easily as I doe teare his paper.

JULIA. Madam, he sends your Ladship this Ring.

SILVIA. The more shame for him, that he sends it me;
For I have heard him say a thousand times,
His *Julia* gave it him, at his departure:
2085 Though his false finger have prophan'd the Ring,
Mine shall not doe his *Julia* so much wrong.

JULIA. She thanks you.

SILVIA. What sai'st thou?

JULIA. I thanke you Madam, that you tender her:
2090 Poore Gentlewoman, my Master wrongs her much.

SILVIA. Do'st thou know her?

JULIA. Almost as well as I doe know my selfe.
To thinke upon her woes, I doe protest
That I have wept a hundred severall times.

2095 *SILVIA*. Belike she thinks that *Protheus* hath forsook her?

JULIA. I thinke she doth: and that's her cause of sorrow.

SILVIA. Is she not passing faire?

JULIA. She hath bin fairer (Madam) then she is,
When she did thinke my Master lov'd her well;
2100 She, in my judgement, was as faire as you.
But since she did neglect her looking-glasse,
And threw her Sun-expelling Masque away,
The ayre hath starv'd the roses in her cheekes,
And pinch'd the lilly-tincture of her face,
2105 That now she is become as blacke as I.

SILVIA. How tall was she?

JULIA. About my stature: for at *Pentecost*,
When all our Pageants of delight were plaid,
Our youth got me to play the womans part,
2110 And I was trim'd in Madam *Julias* gowne,
Which served me as fit, by all mens judgements,
As if the garment had bin made for me:
Therefore I know she is about my height,
And at that time I made her weepe a good,
2115 For I did play a lamentable part.
(Madam) 'twas *Ariadne*, passioning
For *Thesus* perjury, and unjust flight;

Which I so lively acted with my teares:
That my poore Mistris moved therewithall,
2120 Wept bitterly: and would I might be dead,
If I in thought felt not her very sorrow.

SILVIA. She is beholding to thee (gentle youth)
Alas (poore Lady) desolate, and left;
I weepe my selfe to thinke upon thy words:
2125 Here youth: there is my purse; I give thee this
For thy sweet Mistris sake, because thou lov'st her. Fare-well.

JULIA. And she shall thanke you for't, if ere you know her.
A vertuous gentlewoman, milde, and beautifull.
I hope my Masters suit will be but cold,
2130 Since she respects my Mistris love so much.
Alas, how love can trifle with it selfe:
Here is her Picture: let me see, I thinke
If I had such a Tyre, this face of mine
Were full as lovely, as is this of hers;
2135 And yet the Painter flatter'd her a little,
Unlesse I flatter with my selfe too much.
Her haire is *Aburne*, mine is perfect *Yellow*;
If that be all the difference in his love,
Ile get me such a coulour'd Perrywig:
2140 Her eyes are grey as glasse, and so are mine.:
Aye, but her fore-head's low, and mine's as high:
What should it be that he respects in her,
But I can make respective in my selfe?
If this fond Love, were not a blinded god.
2145 Come shadow, come, and take this shadow up,
For 'tis thy rivall: O thou sencelesse forme,
Thou shalt be worship'd, kiss'd, lov'd, and ador'd;
And were there sence in his Idolatry,
My substance should be statue in thy stead.
2150 Ile use thee kindly, for thy Mistris sake
That us'd me so: or else by *Jove*, I vow,
I should have scratch'd out your unseeing eyes,
To make my Master out of love with thee. *Exeunt.*

2155 *A5S1 Milan, outside the abbey wall. Eglamore, Silvia.*

Actus Quintus. Scoena Prima.
Enter Eglamoure, Silvia.

EGLAMORE. The Sun begins to guild the westerne skie,
And now it is about the very houre
2160 That *Silvia*, at Fryer *Patricks* Cell should meet me,
She will not faile; for Lovers breake not houres,
Unlesse it be to come before their time,
So much they spur their expedition.
See where she comes: Lady a happy evening.

2165 *SILVIA.* Amen, Amen: goe on (good *Eglamoure*)
Out at the Posterne by the Abbey wall;
I feare I am attended by some Spies.

EGLAMORE. Feare not: the Forrest is not three leagues off,
If we recover that, we are sure enough. *Exeunt.*

2170

A5S2 Milan, the Duke's palace. Thurio, Protheus, Julia, Duke.

Scoena Secunda.

Enter Thurio, Protheus, Julia, Duke.

THURIO. Sir *Protheus*, what saies *Silvia* to my suit?

2175 *PROTHEUS.* Oh Sir, I finde her milder then she was,
And yet she takes exceptions at your person.

THURIO. What? that my leg is too long?

PROTHEUS. No, that it is too little.

THURIO. Ile weare a Boote, to make it somewhat rounder.

2180 *PROTHEUS.* But love will not be spurd to what it loathes.

THURIO. What saies she to my face?

PROTHEUS. She saies it is a faire one.

THURIO. Nay then the wanton lyes: my face is blacke.

PROTHEUS. But Pearles are faire; and the old saying is,
2185 Blacke men are Pearles, in beauteous Ladies eyes.

THURIO. 'Tis true, such Pearles as put out Ladies eyes,
For I had rather winke, then looke on them.

THURIO. How likes she my discourse?

PROTHEUS. Ill, when you talke of war.

2190 *THURIO.* But well, when I discourse of love and peace.

JULIA. But better indeede, when you hold you peace.

THURIO. What sayes she to my valour?

PROTHEUS. Oh Sir, she makes no doubt of that.

JULIA. She needes not, when she knowes it cowardize.

2195 *THURIO*. What saies she to my birth?

PROTHEUS. That you are well deriv'd.

JULIA. True: from a Gentleman, to a foole.

THURIO. Considers she my Possessions?

PROTHEUS. Oh, aye: and pitties them.

2200 *THURIO*. Wherefore?

JULIA. That such an Asse should owe them.

PROTHEUS. That they are out by Lease.

JULIA. Here comes the Duke.

DUKE. How now Sir *Protheus*; how now *Thurio*?

2205 Which of you saw *Eglamoure* of late?

THURIO. Not I.

PROTHEUS. Nor I.

DUKE. Saw you my daughter?

PROTHEUS. Neither.

2210 *DUKE*. Why then

She's fled unto that pezant, *Valentine*;

And *Eglamoure* is in her Company:

'Tis true: for Frier *Laurence* met them both

As he, in pennance wander'd through the Forrest:

2215 Him he knew well: and guesd that it was she,

But being mask'd, he was not sure of it.

Besides she did intend Confession

At *Patricks* Cell this even, and there she was not.

These likelihoods confirme her flight from hence;

2220 Therefore I pray you stand, not to discourse,

But mount you presently, and meete with me

Upon the rising of the Mountaine foote

That leads toward *Mantua*, whether they are fled:

Dispatch (sweet Gentlemen) and follow me.

2225 *THURIO*. Why this it is, to be a peevish Girle,
That flies her fortune when it followes her:
Ile after; more to be reveng'd on *Eglamoure*,
Then for the love of reck-lesse *Silvia*.

PROTHEUS. And I will follow, more for *Silvas* love
2230 Then hate of *Eglamoure* that goes with her.

JULIA. And I will follow, more to crosse that love
Then hate for *Silvia*, that is gone for love. *Exeunt.*

A5S3 Forest. *Silvia, Out-lawes.*

2235 ***Scena Tertia.***
 Silvia, Out-lawes.

 1*OUTLAW*. Come, come be patient:
We must bring you to our Captaine.

SILVIA. A thousand more mischances then this one
2240 Have learn'd me how to brooke this patiently.

 2*OUTLAW*. Come, bring her away.

 1*OUTLAW*. Where is the Gentleman that was with her?

 3*OUTLAW*. Being nimble footed, he hath out-run us.
But *Moyes* and *Valerius* follow him:
2245 Goe thou with her to the West end of the wood,
There is our Captaine: Wee'll follow him that's fled,
The Thicket is beset, he cannot scape.

 1*OUTLAW*. Come, I must bring you to our Captains cave.
Feare not: he beares an honourable minde,
2250 And will not use a woman lawlesly.

SILVIA. O *Valentine*: this I endure for thee. *Exeunt.*

A5S4 Forest. *Valentine, Protheus, Silvia, Julia, Duke, Thurio, Outlawes.*

Scoena Quarta.
2255 *Enter Valentine, Protheus, Silvia, Julia, Duke, Thurio,*
 Out-lawes.

VALEN. How use doth breed a habit in a man?
This shadowy desart, unfrequented woods
I better brooke then flourishing peopled Townes:
2260 Here can I sit alone, un-seene of any,

And to the Nightingales complaining Notes
Tune my distrestes, and record my woes.
O thou that dost inhabit in my brest,
Leave not the Mansion so long Tenant-lesse,
2265 Lest growing ruinous, the building fall,
And leave no memory of what it was,
Repaire me, with thy presence, *Silvia*:
Thou gentle Nymph, cherish thy for-lorne swaine.

[Enter Protheus, Julia, Silvia]

2270 What hallowing, and what stir is this to day?
These are my mates, that make their wills their Law,
Have some unhappy passenger in chace;
They love me well: yet I have much to doe
To keepe them from uncivill outrages.
2275 Withdraw thee *Valentine*: who's this comes heere?

PROTHEUS. Madam, this service I have done for you
(Though you respect not aught your servant doth)
To hazard life, and reskew you from him,
That would have forc'd your honour, and your love,
2280 Vouchsafe me for my meed, but one faire looke:
(A smaller boone then this I cannot beg,
And lesse then this, I am sure you cannot give.)

VALEN. How like a dreame is this? I see, and heare:
Love, lend me patience to forbear a while.

2285 *SILVIA*. O miserable, unhappy that I am.

PROTHEUS. Unhappy were you (Madam) ere I came:
But by my comming, I have made you happy.

SILVIA. By thy approach thou mak'st me most unhappy.

JULIA. And me, when he approacheth to your presence.

2290 *SILVIA*. Had I beene ceazed by a hungry Lion,
I would have beene a break-fast to the Beast,
Rather then have false *Protheus* reskue me:
Oh heaven be judge how I love *Valentine*,
Whose life's as tender to me as my soule,
2295 And full as much (for more there cannot be)
I doe detest false perjur'd *Protheus*:
Therefore be gone, sollicit me no more.

PROTHEUS. What dangerous action, stood it next to death
Would I not undergoe, for one calme looke:

2300 Oh 'tis the curse in Love, and still approv'd
When women cannot love, where they're belov'd.

SILVIA. When *Protheus* cannot love, where he's belov'd:
Read over *Julia's* heart, (thy first best Love)
For whose deare sake, thou didst then rend thy faith
2305 Into a thousand oathes; and all those oathes,
Descended into perjury, to love me,
Thou hast no faith left now, unlesse thou'dst two,
And that's farre worse then none: better have none
Then plurall faith, which is too much by one:
2310 Thou Counterfeyt, to thy true friend.

PROTHEUS. In Love,
Who respects friend?

SILVIA. All men but *Protheus*.

PROTHEUS. Nay, if the gentle spirit of moving words
2315 Can no way change you to a milder forme;
Ile wooe you like a Souldier, at armes end,
And love you 'gainst the nature of Love: force ye.

SILVIA. Oh heaven.

PROTHEUS. Ile force thee yeeld to my desire.

2320 *VALEN.* Ruffian: let goe that rude uncivill touch,
Thou friend of an ill fashion.

PROTHEUS. *Valentine*.

VALEN. Thou cōmon friend, that's without faith or love,
For such is a friend now: treacherous man,
2325 Thou hast beguil'd my hopes; nought but mine eye
Could have perswaded me: now I dare not say
I have one friend alive; thou wouldst disprove me:
Who should be trusted, when ones right hand
Is perjured to the bosome? *Protheus*
2330 I am sorry I must never trust thee more,
But count the world a stranger for thy sake:
The private wound is deepest: oh time, most accurst:
'Mongst all foes that a friend should be the worst?

PROTHEUS. My shame and guilt confounds me:
2335 Forgive me *Valentine*: if hearty sorrow
Be a sufficient Ransome for offence,

I tender't heere: I doe as truely suffer,
As ere I did commit.

VALEN. Then I am paid:

2340 And once againe, I doe receive thee honest;
Who by Repentance is not satisfied,
Is nor of heaven, nor earth; for these are pleas'd:
By Penitence th' Eternalls wrath's appeas'd:
And that my love may appeare plaine and free,
2345 All that was mine, in *Silvia*, I give thee.

JULIA. Oh me unhappy.

PROTHEUS. Looke to the Boy.

VALEN. Why, Boy?

Why wag: how now? what's the matter? look up: speak.

2350 JULIA. O good sir, my master charg'd me to deliver a ring
to Madam *Silvia*: w (out of my neglect) was never done.

PROTHEUS. Where is that ring? boy?

JULIA. Heere 'tis: this is it.

PROTHEUS. How? let me see.

2355 Why this is the ring I gave to *Julia*.

JULIA. Oh, cry you mercy sir, I have mistooke:
This is the ring you sent to *Silvia*.

PROTHEUS. But how cam'st thou by this ring? at my depart
I gave this unto *Julia*.

2360 JULIA. And *Julia* her selfe did give it me,
And *Julia* her selfe hath brought it hither.

PROTHEUS. How? *Julia*?

JULIA. Behold her, that gave ayme to all thy oathes,
And entertain'd 'em deeply in her heart.

2365 How oft hast thou with perjury cleft the roote?
Oh *Protheus*, let this habit make thee blush.
Be thou asham'd that I have tooke upon me,
Such an immodest rayment; if shame live
In a disguise of love?

2370 It is the lesser blot modesty findes,
Women to change their shapes, then men their minds.

PROTHEUS. Then men their minds? tis true: oh heven, were man
But Constant, he were perfect; that one error
Fils him with faults: makes him run through all th' sins;
2375 Inconstancy falls-off, ere it begins:
What is in *Silvia's* face, but I may spie
More fresh in *Julia's*, with a constant eye?

VALEN. Come, come: a hand from either:
Let me be blest to make this happy close:
2380 'Twere pittie two such friends should be long foes.

PROTHEUS. Beare witnes (heaven) I have my wish for ever.

JULIA. And I mine.

[Enter Duke, Outlaws, Thurio]

1OUTLAW. A prize: a prize: a prize.

2385 *VALEN*. Forbeare, forbeare I say: It is my Lord the *Duke*.
Your Grace is welcome to a man disgrac'd,
Banished *Valentine*.

DUKE. Sir *Valentine*?

THURIO. Yonder is *Silvia*: and *Silvia's* mine.

2390 *VALEN*. *Thurio* give backe; or else embrace thy death:
Come not within the measure of my wrath:
Doe not name *Silvia* thine: if once againe,
Verona shall not hold thee: heere she stands,
Take but possession of her, with a Touch:
2395 I dare thee, but to breath upon my Love.

THURIO. Sir *Valentine*, I care not for her, aye:
I hold him but a foole that will endanger
His Body, for a Girle that loves him not:
I claime her not, and therefore she is thine.

2400 *DUKE*. The more degenerate and base art thou
To make such meanes for her, as thou hast done,
And leave her on such slight conditions.
Now, by the honor of my Ancestry,
I doe applaud thy spirit, *Valentine*,
2405 And thinke thee worthy of an Empresse love:
Know then, I heere forget all former greefes,
Cancell all grudge, repeale thee home againe,
Plead a new state in thy un-rival'd merit,
To which I thus subscribe: Sir *Valentine*,

2410 Thou art a Gentleman, and well deriv'd,
Take thou thy *Silvia*, for thou hast deserv'd her.

VALEN. I thank your Grace, ye gift hath made me happy:
I now beseech you (for your daughters sake)
To grant one Boone that I shall aske of you.

2415 DUKE. I grant it (for thine owne) what ere it be.

VALEN. These banish'd men, that I have kept withall,
Are men endu'd with worthy qualities:
Forgive them what they have committed here,
And let them be recall'd from their Exile:

2420 They are reformed, civill, full of good,
And fit for great employment (worthy Lord.)

DUKE. Thou hast prevaild, I pardon them and thee:
Dispose of them, as thou knowst their deserts.
Come, let us goe, we will include all jarres,

2425 With Triumphes, Mirth, and rare solemnity.

VALEN. And as we walke along, I dare be bold
With our discourse, to make your Grace to smile.
What thinke you of this Page (my Lord?)

DUKE. I think the Boy hath grace in him, he blushes.

2430 VALEN. I warrant you (my Lord) more grace, then Boy.

DUKE. What meane you by that saying?

VALEN. Please you, Ile tell you, as we passe along,
That you will wonder what hath fortun'd:
Come *Protheus*, 'tis your pennance, but to heare

2435 The story of your Loves discovered.
That done, our day of marriage shall be yours,
One Feast, one house, one mutuall happinesse. *Exeunt.*

FINIS.

The names of all the Actors.

2440 Duke: Father to *Silvia*.

Valentine.}

Protheus. } the two Gentlemen.

Anthonio: father to *Protheus*.

Thurio: a foolish rivall to *Valentine*.

2445 *Eglamoure*: Agent for *Silvia* in her escape.

Host: where *Julia* lodges.

Out-lawes with *Valentine*.

Speed: a clownish servant to *Valentine*.

2450 *Launce: the like to Protheus.*
Panthion: servant to Antonio.
Julia: beloved of Protheus.
Silvia: beloved of Valentine.
Lucetta: waighting-woman to Julia.

- i What are they doing in Padua? It's in the opposite direction. But it is on the water, so it is a place to sail from with Shakespeare's conceit that one gets from Verona to Milan by water. Which is impossible.
- ii https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/True_lover%27s_knot